PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

PRD Forge Viewer

The author reads the whole PRD and its grades in one place, sees changes as they happen, and sends stakeholders a themed export marked with its version and draft status.

VERSION	0.3.4
STATUS	draft
OWNER	Richard Hightower
DOMAIN	software product management
CREATED	2026-10-26
UPDATED	2026-10-26
GOLDEN THREAD	J-001
STAKEHOLDERS	Engineering lead (PER-003); Product sponsor (PER-004); Developers (PER-002, PER-005)

Executive summary

PROBLEM	A PRD Forge set is 18 linked files. Authors cannot read it as one document or see all grades at once, and stakeholders without the authoring tools cannot read it, so feedback waits.
USERS	PRD authors and developers who use the authoring tools, and the engineering lead, sponsor, and developers who read the exported PRD.
WHY NOW	The authoring tools had their first release in October 2026, and teams adopt them only if stakeholders can review a PRD without them.
BET	The author reads the whole PRD and its grades in one place, sees changes as they happen, and sends stakeholders a themed export marked with its version and draft status.
MEASURE	Median days from sending a PRD version to the first stakeholder feedback: target 2 days or less by 2027-03-31; baseline about 10 days (owner estimate).

Contents

§	SECTION	STATUS	GRADE	BLOCKING
1	Problem and opportunity	final	75/100	—
2	Target customer and market	final	70/100	—
3	Objectives and success metrics	final	83/100	—
4	Users and personas	final	86/100	—
5	User journeys	final	90/100	—
5	Scenarios	final	92/100	—
6	Scope	final	92/100	—
7	Functional requirements	draft	91/100	1
7	Wireframes	review	94/100	—
8	Non-functional requirements	final	86/100	—
9	Constraints	final	75/100	—
10	Decision rights	final	96/100	—
11	Assumptions, risks, and dependencies	final	96/100	—
12	Open questions	draft	—	—
13	Release plan	final	92/100	—
14	Glossary	draft	—	—

§	SECTION	STATUS	GRADE	BLOCKING
15	Change log	draft	—	—

About this document

PRD authors cannot read an 18-file PRD Forge set as one document or see every grade at once. Stakeholders without the authoring tools cannot read it at all, so feedback waits. The viewer shows the whole set and its grades in one place, shows changes as the authoring tools make them, searches, and makes themed export files marked with the version and draft status (formats in C-001). Release 1 is due 2026-10-26 and delivers J-001, the golden thread. Success is feedback within 2 days of sending a version, by 2027-03-31.

SECTION	DOCUMENT
1	Problem and opportunity
2	Target customer and market
3	Objectives and success metrics
4	Users and personas
5	User journeys and Scenarios
6	Scope
7	Functional requirements
7	Wireframes
8	Non-functional requirements
9	Constraints
10	Decision rights
11	Assumptions, risks, and dependencies
12	Open questions
13	Release plan
14	Glossary
15	Change log

SECTION 1

Problem and opportunity

FINAL 75/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

The authoring tools are new. They help teams write PRDs as a PRD set of 18 linked files. This PRD is one of the first PRD sets made with them.

ID	PROBLEM	WHO
P-001	The author cannot see the whole PRD, go to one section, or find one item	PER-001, PER-002
P-002	A stakeholder without the authoring tools cannot read the PRD	PER-001, PER-003, PER-004, PER-005
P-003	The author cannot see at a glance which sections are weak	PER-001

P-001. The author cannot see the whole PRD or go directly to one section

The PRD is 18 separate files, so a discussion about one section, requirement, or scenario starts with a search through the files.

- **Evidence.** A PRD set has 18 files. No usage counts exist yet (Q-001).
- **Why now.** The authoring tools are new, and their adoption depends on readable output.
- **Cost of inaction.** Not measured. The expected cost is time lost to finding sections during reviews, and authors who stop using the authoring tools (Q-001).

P-002. A stakeholder without the authoring tools cannot read the PRD

Feedback waits until the author packages the PRD by hand.

- **Evidence.** The set is plain-text files with machine-readable headers. The only export today runs from a command line and has one fixed appearance. The number of stakeholders per PRD is not known (Q-002).
- **Why now.** Teams adopt the authoring tools only if stakeholders can review a PRD without them.
- **Cost of inaction.** About 10 calendar days of waiting for the first feedback on each version (owner estimate), against a 2-day target (O-001).

P-003. The author cannot see at a glance which sections are weak

The grade, the count of blocking defects, and what is missing are in each file separately.

- **Evidence.** A score, a blocking count, and a grade date are in each of the 17 section documents. The findings behind each grade are not kept (Q-004).
- **Why now.** The authoring tools grade every section.
- **Cost of inaction.** Not measured. The expected cost is weak sections that go to stakeholders before the author fixes them (Q-004).

> **P-001**
>
> STATEMENT — The author cannot see the whole PRD in one place, go directly to one section, or find one item such as a requirement or a scenario. The PRD is 18 separate files, so a discussion about one item starts with a search through the files.

WHO	PRD author (PER-001), and a developer who uses the authoring tools (PER-002)
EVIDENCE	• A PRD set has 18 files: one index and 17 section documents (the authoring tools' document layout, first release). • No usage counts exist. The authoring tools are new, and this PRD is one of the first sets made with them. See Q-001.
WHY NOW	The authoring tools had their first release in October 2026. Their adoption depends on whether authors find a finished PRD easy to read and discuss.
COST OF INACTION	Not measured. The expected cost is time lost to finding sections during reviews, and authors who stop using the authoring tools. See Q-001.

P-002

STATEMENT	A stakeholder who does not use the authoring tools cannot read the PRD. Feedback waits until the author packages the PRD by hand.
WHO	PRD author (PER-001), and the readers of the export (PER-003, PER-004, PER-005)
EVIDENCE	• A PRD set is plain-text files with machine-readable headers. A reader without the authoring tools sees raw text. • The only export today runs from a command line inside the authoring tools. It has one fixed appearance. • Before PRD Forge, the first stakeholder feedback on a PRD took about 10 calendar days (estimate by the PRD owner from past PRDs, 2026-10-26). • The number of stakeholders per PRD, and how many have the tools, is not known. See Q-002.
WHY NOW	The authoring tools had their first release in October 2026. Teams adopt them only if stakeholders can review a PRD without them.
COST OF INACTION	About 10 calendar days of waiting for the first feedback on each PRD version (owner estimate), against a target of 2 days (O-001). See Q-001.

P-003

STATEMENT	The author cannot see at a glance which sections are weak. The grade, the count of blocking defects, and what is missing are in each file separately.
WHO	PRD author (PER-001)
EVIDENCE	• The authoring tools record a score, a count of blocking defects, and a grade date in each of the 17 section documents. The findings behind each grade are reported in the conversation and are not kept in the PRD set (Q-004).
WHY NOW	The authoring tools grade every section from their first release. The grades are only useful if the author can act on them.
COST OF INACTION	Not measured. The expected cost is weak sections that go to stakeholders before the author fixes them. See Q-004.

SECTION 2

Target customer and market

FINAL 70/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

The viewer is free and open source for anyone who uses PRD Forge. The PRD owner decided this on 2026-10-26. Nobody buys it, so the market is the number of teams that use PRD Forge, which is not known yet.

ID	SEGMENT	USER	SIZE
S-001	Teams that write PRDs with PRD Forge	PER-001, PER-002	Not known (R-002)
S-002	Stakeholders who read those PRDs	PER-003, PER-004, PER-005	Not known (Q-002)

ALTERNATIVE	OUR EDGE
Status quo: 18 files in a text editor	One place to read, grades in one view, an export that anyone opens
The command-line export	Select sections and theme, no command line
The stepper pane in the authoring tools	Readers without the tools can use it, and it searches and exports

Why we win: a PRD author gets a readable, themed copy to stakeholders without extra work, and the viewer costs nothing.

Segments

S-001 · Teams that write PRDs with PRD Forge

BUYER	Nobody buys it. The viewer is free and open source. The PRD author chooses to install it.
USER	PER-001, PER-002
SIZE	Not known. PRD Forge had its first release in October 2026 (R-002, Q-001).
WILLINGNESS TO PAY	None needed. The viewer is free.

S-002 · Stakeholders who read PRDs from those teams

BUYER	Nobody buys it. They receive exports and can install the free viewer.
USER	PER-003, PER-004, PER-005
SIZE	Not known (Q-002).
WILLINGNESS TO PAY	None needed. The viewer is free.

Competitors

The status quo, reading the files in a text editor

OFFER	The author and developers open each of the 18 files separately. The stakeholders get the files or a copy that the author makes by hand.
OUR EDGE	The author reads the whole set and every grade in one place, and sends a file that stakeholders open without the authoring tools.

The command-line export of the authoring tools

OFFER	One PDF and one Word file of the whole set, in one fixed appearance.
OUR EDGE	The author selects the sections and the theme, and does not need a command line.

The stepper pane of the authoring tools

OFFER	Steps through the sections one at a time, inside the authoring tools.
OUR EDGE	A developer or reader without the authoring tools can use the viewer, and it searches and exports.

SECTION 3

Objectives and success metrics

FINAL 83/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

ID	OBJECTIVE	METRIC	BASELINE	TARGET	BY	OWNER
O-001	Stakeholders give feedback sooner	Median days from send to first written feedback	About 10 days (owner estimate)	2 days or less	2027-03-31	Richard Hightower
O-002	Blocking defects fixed before sending	Blocking defects in a version on the day it is sent	1 (this PRD, 0.2.0)	0	2027-03-31	Richard Hightower

O-001. Stakeholders give feedback on a PRD version sooner

Metric: median calendar days from the day the author sends a PRD version to a stakeholder, to the day of the first written feedback from any stakeholder on that version. Serves P-001 and P-002.

Baseline: about 10 calendar days, from past PRDs written before PRD Forge. This is an estimate by the PRD owner on 2026-10-26. The first send of this PRD replaces it with a measured figure (Q-001).

Target: 2 days or less by 2027-03-31. Owner: Richard Hightower, PRD owner.

O-002. Authors fix blocking defects before stakeholders see a version

Metric: the count of blocking defects in a PRD version on the day the author sends it. Serves P-003. Baseline: 1, in version 0.2.0 of this PRD. Target: 0 in every version sent, by 2027-03-31.

> **O-001 · Stakeholders give feedback on a PRD version sooner.**
>
> METRIC — Median calendar days from the day the author sends a PRD version to a stakeholder, to the day of the first written feedback from any stakeholder on that version.
>
> BASELINE — About 10 calendar days, from past PRDs written before PRD Forge (estimate by the PRD owner, 2026-10-26). The first send of this PRD replaces it with a measured figure (Q-001).
>
> TARGET — 2 days or less
>
> BY — 2027-03-31
>
> OWNER — Richard Hightower, PRD owner

> **O-002 · Authors fix blocking defects before stakeholders see a version.**
>
> METRIC — Count of blocking defects in a PRD version on the day the author sends it to a stakeholder, read from the grades in the export.
>
> BASELINE — 1 blocking defect in version 0.2.0 of this PRD, sent on or after 2026-10-26.
>
> TARGET — 0 blocking defects in every version sent
>
> BY — 2027-03-31
>
> OWNER — Richard Hightower, PRD owner

SECTION 4

Users and personas

FINAL 86/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

PER-001 is the primary persona. Release 1 is designed around the PRD author. The personas work in a consulting engagement: the author's firm writes the PRD, and the client's executive approves it. PER-003, PER-004, and PER-005 usually read the exported PRD. They can also use the viewer, so it must be usable without training.

ID	PERSONA	USES THE AUTHORING TOOLS	READS THE PRD IN	AUTHORITY
PER-001	PRD author, senior consultant or product lead	Yes	The viewer	Owns the PRD
PER-002	Developer with the authoring tools	Yes	The viewer	Chooses own items and exports
PER-003	Engineering lead, client or delivery team	Usually no	The export	Reviews
PER-004	Product sponsor, client executive	No	The export	Approves
PER-005	Developer without the authoring tools	No	The export	None

PER-001. PRD author

"Show me what is weak, then let me send it today." Goals: see the whole PRD and go to one section, see which sections are weak, and send the PRD to stakeholders quickly. Pains: P-001, P-002, P-003. Authority: owns the PRD and cannot approve it.

PER-002. Developer who uses the authoring tools

Goals: find the requirements, stories, and scenarios for the current work, and export a part of the PRD. Pain: P-001. Authority: chooses own items and exports; cannot approve the PRD.

PER-003. Engineering lead

Goals: decide if the team can build from the PRD, and send back what is missing. Pain: P-002. Authority: reviews, does not approve.

PER-004. Product sponsor

"Two pages, then I decide." Goal: read a short summary and approve or reject the PRD. Journey: J-003. Pain: P-002. Authority: the only persona who approves.

PER-005. Developer who does not use the authoring tools

Goal: read the sections for the current work. Pain: P-002. Authority: none.

PER-001

NAME	PRD author, a senior consultant or product lead at a consulting firm, who uses the authoring tools
SHORT NAME	Author
GOALS	• Show me what is weak, then let me send it today. • See the whole PRD and go directly to the section under discussion • See which sections are weak and what to fix before anyone else reads them • Send the PRD to stakeholders quickly, in a form they can read without the tools
PAINS	• The PRD is 18 files, and finding one section or one item takes a search (P-001) • Stakeholders cannot read the files without the tools (P-002) • Grades and gaps are spread across 17 files (P-003)
FREQUENCY	Opens the viewer several times a day while writing a PRD (Q-003). Exports once for each version sent to stakeholders, including draft versions.
AUTHORITY	Owns the PRD. Chooses which PRD set to open. Decides its content, which sections to fix, and the status of each section, which decides the draft mark. Chooses the format, theme, and sections of an export, and which version to send to whom. Cannot approve it.
PROFICIENCY	Expert in the business domain. Uses the authoring tools. Often not an experienced product manager.

PER-002

NAME	Developer on the consulting delivery team who uses the authoring tools but did not write the PRD
SHORT NAME	ToolsDeveloper
GOALS	• Give me the requirements for my story, nothing else. • Find the requirements, stories, and scenarios for the current work without reading the whole PRD • Export a part of the PRD to share with the team
PAINS	• Finding one requirement or scenario across 18 files takes a search (P-001)
FREQUENCY	Not known (Q-003).
AUTHORITY	Chooses which PRD set to open. Decides which items apply to own work, and the format, theme, and sections of an export to share. Cannot approve the PRD.
PROFICIENCY	Expert in software and in the authoring tools. May not know the business domain.

PER-003 · Engineering lead on the client or delivery team that builds the product

SHORT NAME	EngineeringLead
GOALS	• Can my team build this, yes or no? • Decide if the team can build the product from this PRD • Find what is missing or unclear, and send it back to the author
PAINS	• Does not use the authoring tools, so cannot read the set without an export (P-002)
FREQUENCY	Reads once for each version received, including drafts.
AUTHORITY	Reviews and comments. Decides if the team can build from the PRD. Does not approve it.
PROFICIENCY	Expert in software. Usually does not use the authoring tools.

PER-004 · Product sponsor, a client executive who approves the PRD

SHORT NAME	Sponsor
GOALS	• Two pages, then I decide. • Read a short summary and decide to approve or reject the PRD
PAINS	• Cannot read the set without the authoring tools, and will not read 18 files (P-002)
FREQUENCY	Reads once for each version received, including drafts.
AUTHORITY	Approves or rejects the PRD. The only persona who approves.
PROFICIENCY	Expert in the business. Does not use the authoring tools. Reads a few pages only.

PER-005 · Developer on the client or delivery team who does not use the authoring tools

SHORT NAME	TeamDeveloper
GOALS	• Send me the part I need. • Read the sections that apply to the current work
PAINS	• Cannot read the set without an export (P-002)
FREQUENCY	Reads once for each version received, including drafts.
AUTHORITY	None for the PRD.
PROFICIENCY	Expert in software. Does not use the authoring tools.

SECTION 5

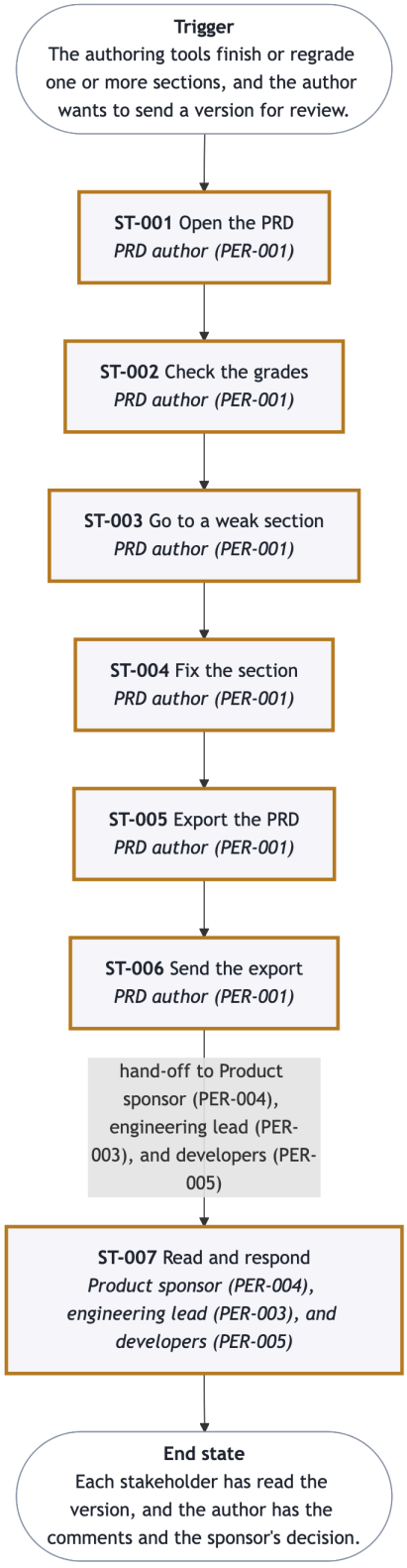
User journeys

FINAL 90/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

J-001 is the golden thread: the one journey that release 1 must deliver end to end.

ID	PERSONA	GOAL	STAGES	GOLDEN THREAD
J-001	PER-001 PRD author	Stakeholders read the PRD and the author has their feedback	ST-001 to ST-007	Yes
J-003	PER-004 Product sponsor	The sponsor approves or rejects a version	ST-011 to ST-012	No
J-002	PER-002 Developer with the authoring tools	The developer has the items for the current work and shares them	ST-008 to ST-010	No

J-001. The author sends a reviewed PRD to stakeholders



J-001 journey diagram

Trigger: the authoring tools finish or regrade sections, and the author wants to send a version for review.

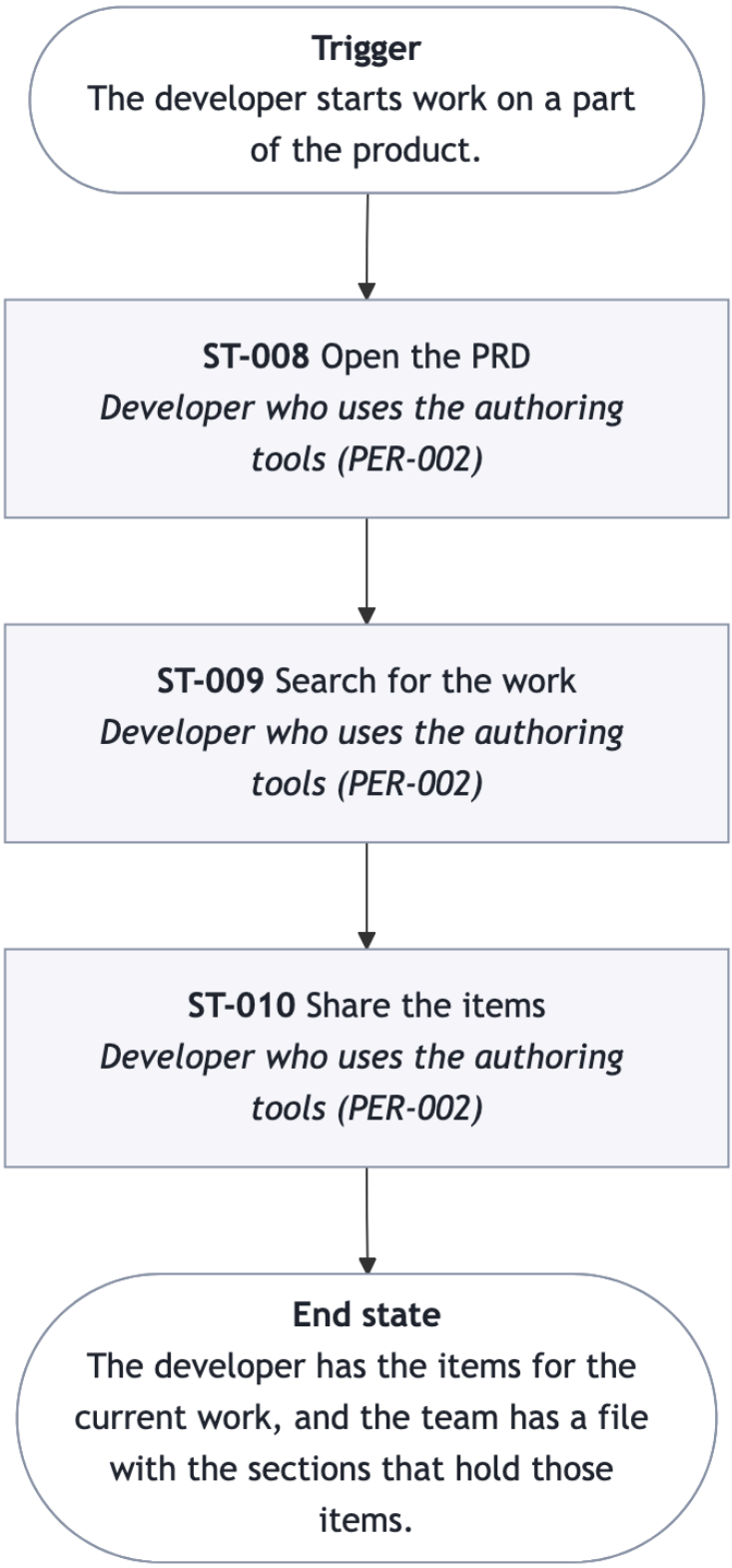
STAGE	ACTOR	DECISION
ST-001. Open the PRD	PRD author	Is this the correct PRD and version?

STAGE	ACTOR	DECISION
ST-002. Check the grades	PRD author	Which sections must be fixed first?
ST-003. Go to a weak section	PRD author	Fix it now, or send it as a draft?
ST-004. Fix the section	PRD author, in the authoring tools	Is the section good enough to send?
ST-005. Export the PRD	PRD author	Which format, theme, and sections?
ST-006. Send the export	PRD author	Who receives this version?
ST-007. Read and respond	Sponsor, engineering lead, developers	Approve or reject, and comment

The author fixes sections in the authoring tools, not in the viewer. The viewer shows the change without any action from the author. ST-006 and ST-007 happen outside the viewer.

End state: each stakeholder has read the version, and the author has the comments and the sponsor's decision.

J-002. A developer finds and shares the items for the current work



J-002 journey diagram

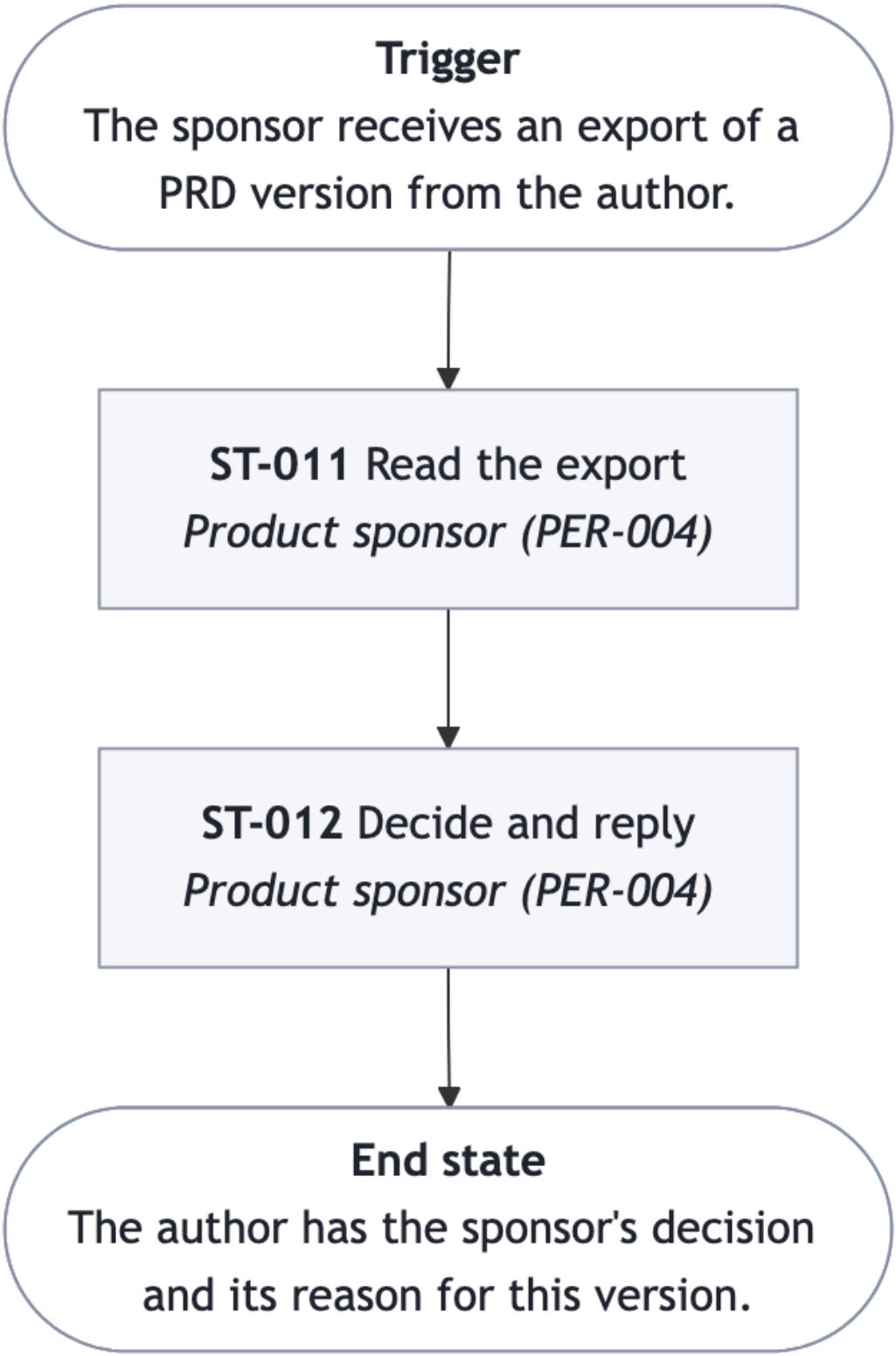
Trigger: the developer starts work on a part of the product.

STAGE	ACTOR	DECISION
ST-008. Open the PRD	Developer with the authoring tools	Is this the correct PRD and version?

STAGE	ACTOR	DECISION
ST-009. Search for the work	Developer with the authoring tools	Which items apply to the current work?
ST-010. Share the items	Developer with the authoring tools	Which sections does the team need?

End state: the developer has the items for the current work, and the team has a file with those items.

J-003. The sponsor approves or rejects a version



J-003 journey diagram

Trigger: the sponsor receives an export of a PRD version.

STAGE	ACTOR	DECISION
ST-011. Read the export	Product sponsor	Is there enough here to decide?

STAGE	ACTOR	DECISION
ST-012. Decide and reply	Product sponsor	Approve or reject this version

End state: the author has the sponsor's decision and its reason. Both stages happen outside the viewer. The export must carry what the sponsor needs (FR-014, FR-019).

J-001

GOAL	Stakeholders have a version of the PRD they can read without the tools, and the author has their feedback.
PERSONA	PER-001
TRIGGER	The authoring tools finish or regrade one or more sections, and the author wants to send a version for review.
GOLDEN THREAD	yes

STAGES

Open the PRD

ID	ST-001
ACTOR	PRD author (PER-001)
STEPS	• The author opens the PRD set. • The author sees the product name, the version, the executive summary, and the status of every section.
INPUTS	• The PRD set
OUTPUTS	• The whole PRD, with the status of every section
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a PRD set with 18 documents, when the author opens it, then the author sees the product name, the version, and the status of every document in order.
DECISION	Is this the correct PRD and version?

Check the grades

ID	ST-002
ACTOR	PRD author (PER-001)
STEPS	• The author sees the score, the count of blocking defects, and the grade date for each section. • The author sees which sections are pending, draft, review, or final.
INPUTS	• The grades that the authoring tools recorded
OUTPUTS	• A list of the sections that are weak or not started
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a set with graded and ungraded sections, when the author checks the grades, then the author sees the score, blocking count, and grade date of each graded section, and which sections are not graded.
DECISION	Which sections must be fixed before anyone else reads the PRD?

Go to a weak section

ID	ST-003
ACTOR	PRD author (PER-001)
STEPS	• The author goes directly to a section, or searches for an item such as a requirement or a scenario. • The author reads the section and sees its status, score, and count of blocking defects.
INPUTS	• A section name, or a search term and a category
OUTPUTS	• The section or the item, with its status and grade
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a weak section, when the author selects it or searches for one of its items, then the author reads it with its status, score, and blocking count.
DECISION	Fix the section now, or send the PRD as a draft?

Fix the section

ID	ST-004
ACTOR	PRD author (PER-001)

STEPS	• The author fixes the section in the authoring tools, outside the viewer. • The author sees the changed section and its new grade in the viewer, without any action in the viewer.
INPUTS	• The author's answers to the wizard
OUTPUTS	• The changed section, with its new grade
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author reads a section in the viewer, when the authoring tools save a new version of it, then the author sees the new text and grade without any action.
DECISION	Is the section good enough to send?

Export the PRD

ID	ST-005
ACTOR	PRD author (PER-001)
STEPS	• The author selects a document format that the readers open without the authoring tools. • The author selects an export theme. • The author selects the whole PRD or some sections. • The author saves or prints the export.
INPUTS	• The format, the theme, and the sections
OUTPUTS	• One file that a reader can open without the tools, or a printed copy
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author selects a format, a theme, and some sections, when the author exports, then the author has one file with only those sections, in that theme, that a reader opens without the authoring tools.
DECISION	Which format, theme, and sections do these readers need?

Send the export

ID	ST-006
ACTOR	PRD author (PER-001)
STEPS	• The author sends the file to the stakeholders, outside the viewer.
INPUTS	• The exported file
OUTPUTS	• The stakeholders have the file
ACCEPTANCE	• Given an exported file, when the author sends it, then each chosen stakeholder has the file.
DECISION	Who receives this version?
HANDOFF	Product sponsor (PER-004), engineering lead (PER-003), and developers (PER-005)

Read and respond

ID	ST-007
ACTOR	Product sponsor (PER-004), engineering lead (PER-003), and developers (PER-005)

STEPS	• Each reader opens the file and sees the version, and sees if it is a draft. • The engineering lead and the developers reply with comments. • The sponsor approves or rejects the version.
INPUTS	• The exported file
OUTPUTS	• Comments, and the sponsor's approval or rejection
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a stakeholder has the file, when the stakeholder opens it, then the stakeholder sees the version and if it is a draft, and can reply with comments or a decision.
DECISION	The sponsor approves or rejects. The engineering lead decides if the team can build from it.
HANDOFF	PRD author (PER-001), who receives the feedback

PAIN POINTS

- The PRD is 18 files, so finding one section or item takes a search (P-001).
- The grades and gaps are in 17 separate files (P-003).
- Readers without the tools cannot read the files (P-002).
- While the authoring tools change a section, the author cannot be sure that the view is current.
- A reader of a draft cannot tell that it is a draft.

NEEDS

- One view of the whole PRD, with direct access to each section and a search for items.
- One view of the grades, blocking defects, and gaps of all sections.
- An export in a format that a reader opens without the tools, in a theme the author selects.
- The view shows each change to a section without any action from the author.
- The export shows the version and the status of the PRD and of each section.

END STATE

Each stakeholder has read the version, and the author has the comments and the sponsor's decision.

J-002

GOAL

The developer has the sections and items for the current work, such as requirements, journeys, and scenarios, and can share those sections with the team.

PERSONA

PER-002

TRIGGER

The developer starts work on a part of the product.

STAGES

Open the PRD

ID	ST-008
ACTOR	Developer who uses the authoring tools (PER-002)
STEPS	• The developer opens the PRD set and sees the list of sections.
INPUTS	• The PRD set
OUTPUTS	• The whole PRD
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a PRD set, when the developer opens it, then the developer sees the version and the list of sections.
DECISION	Is this the correct PRD and version?

Search for the work

ID	ST-009
ACTOR	Developer who uses the authoring tools (PER-002)
STEPS	• The developer enters a search term and selects a category, such as requirements, journeys, or scenarios, or all. • The developer sees the best matches first, each with its section and id. • The developer opens a match and follows its links to related items.
INPUTS	• A search term and a category
OUTPUTS	• The matching items, best match first
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a search term and a category, when the developer searches, then the developer sees the matching items best first, each with its id and section, and opens one in one action.
DECISION	Which items apply to the current work?

Share the items

ID	ST-010
ACTOR	Developer who uses the authoring tools (PER-002)
STEPS	• The developer exports the selected sections in a document format the team opens without the authoring tools, or prints them. • The developer sends the file to the team, outside the viewer.
INPUTS	• The selected sections, the format, and the theme
OUTPUTS	• One file with only those sections
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the developer selects two sections, when the developer exports them, then the team has one file with only those two sections.
DECISION	Which sections does the team need?
HANDOFF	Developers on the team (PER-005)

PAIN POINTS

- Finding one requirement or scenario in 18 files takes a search (P-001).
- The team needs only the sections for the current work, not the whole PRD.

NEEDS

- A search by term and category, with the best matches first.
- An export of selected sections only.

END STATE — The developer has the items for the current work, and the team has a file with the sections that hold those items.

J-003 · The sponsor approves or rejects a version of the PRD, with a reason.

PERSONA — PER-004

TRIGGER — The sponsor receives an export of a PRD version from the author.

STAGES

Read the export

ID — ST-011

ACTOR — Product sponsor (PER-004)

STEPS
- The sponsor opens the file without the authoring tools.
- The sponsor sees the version and if it is a draft on the first page.
- The sponsor reads the executive summary and the contents list with the status and score of each section.

INPUTS
- The exported file

OUTPUTS
- The sponsor knows what the PRD proposes and how complete it is

ACCEPTANCE
- Given an export of a draft version, when the sponsor opens it, then the first page shows the version and the word Draft, then the summary and the status and score of every section.

DECISION — Is there enough here to decide, or must the author answer questions first?

Decide and reply

ID — ST-012

ACTOR — Product sponsor (PER-004)

STEPS
- The sponsor approves or rejects the version, outside the viewer.
- The sponsor sends the decision and the reason to the author.

INPUTS
- The sponsor's reading of the export

OUTPUTS
- An approval or a rejection, with a reason

ACCEPTANCE
- Given the sponsor decided on a version, when the sponsor replies, then the author has the decision and its reason.

DECISION — Approve or reject this version.

HANDOFF — PRD author (PER-001), who records the decision in the change log

PAIN POINTS
- The sponsor will not read 18 files to make a decision (P-002).

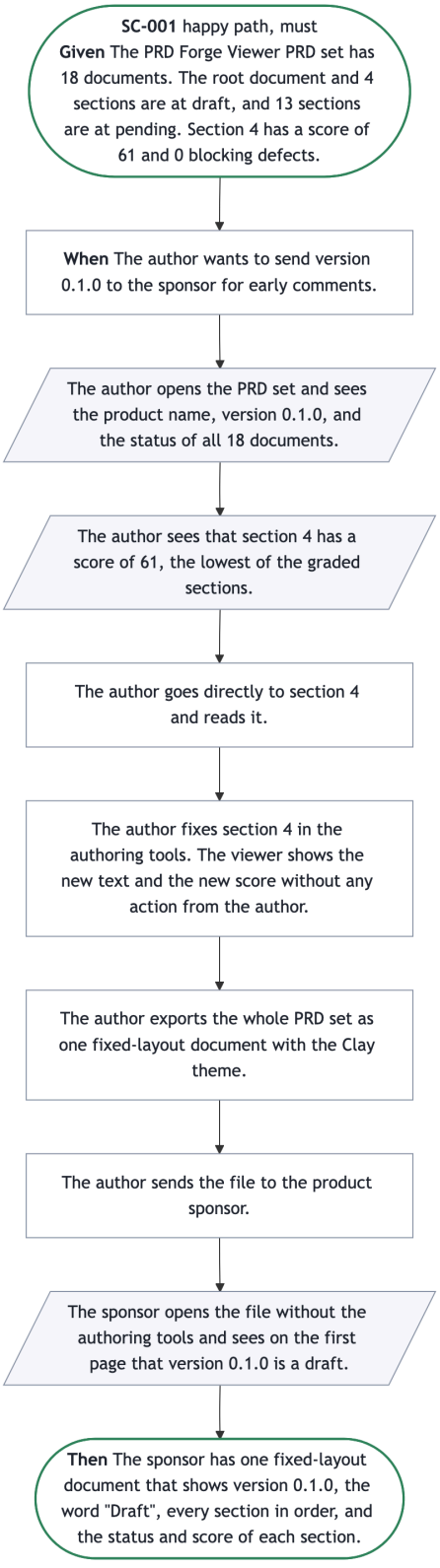
NEEDS
- One short file that starts with the version, the draft mark, the summary, and the status of every section.

END STATE — The author has the sponsor's decision and its reason for this version.

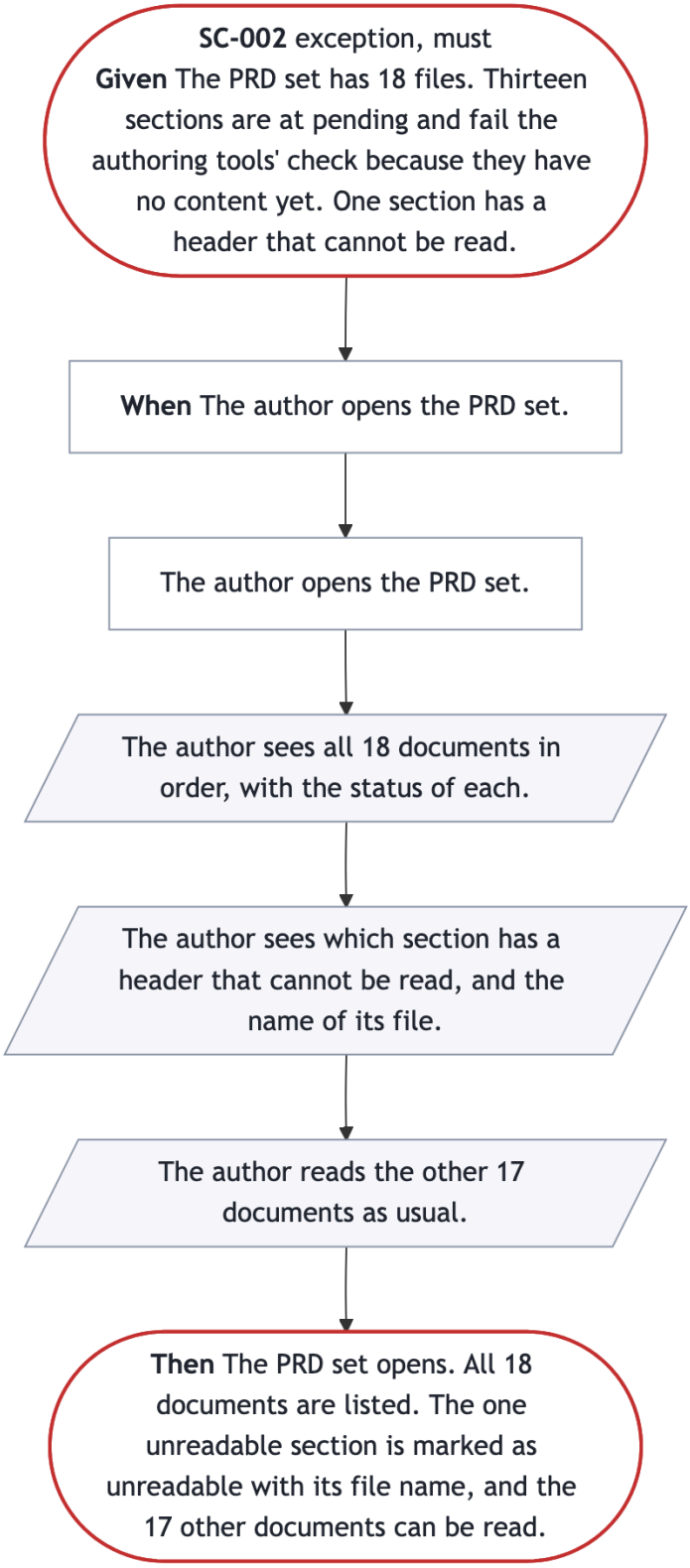
SECTION 5

Scenarios

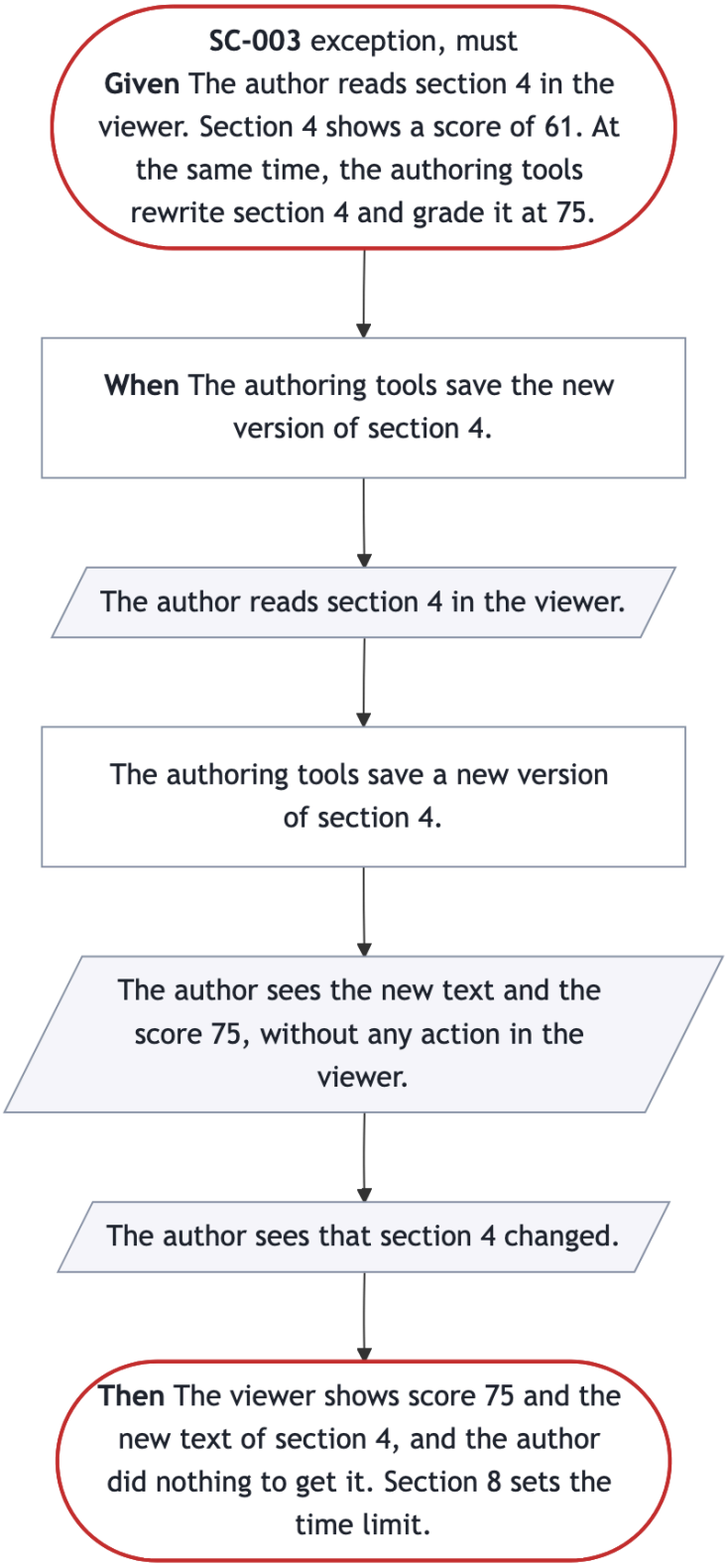
FINAL 92/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS



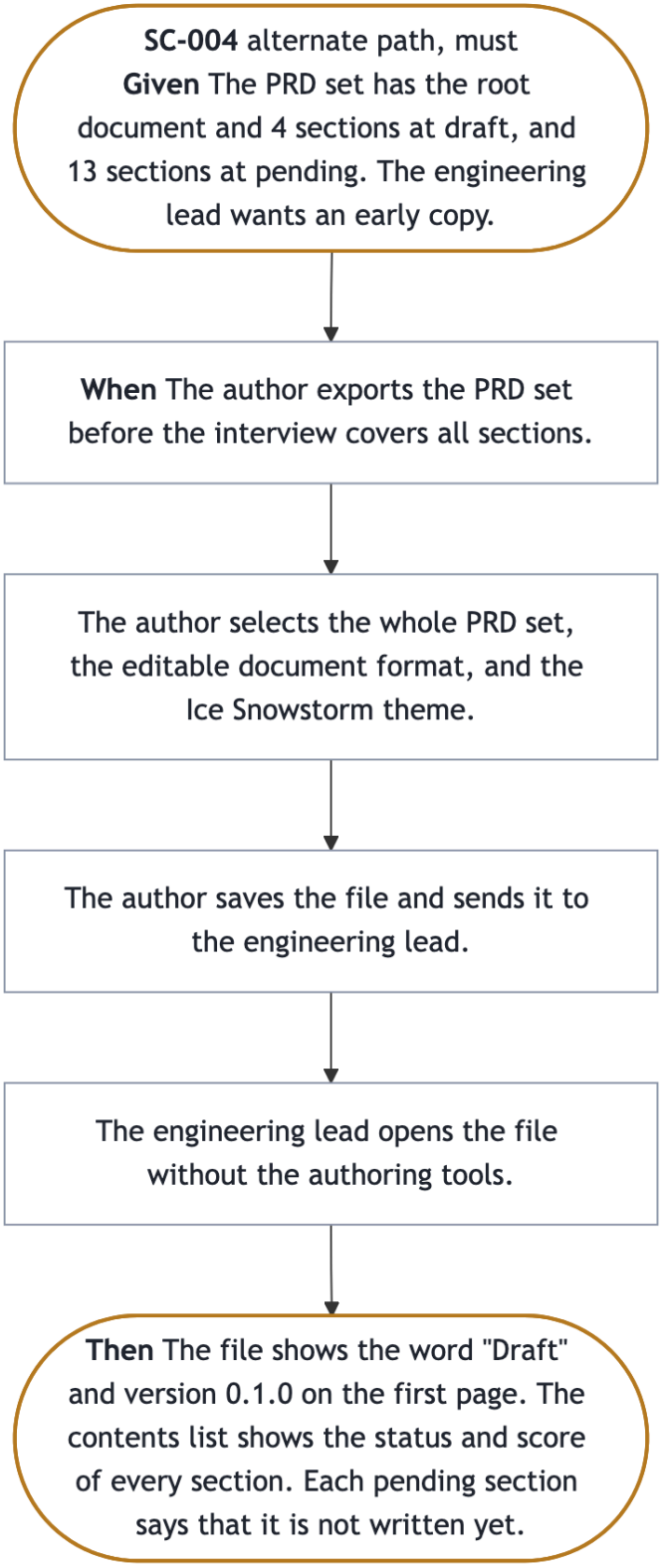
SC-001 scenario



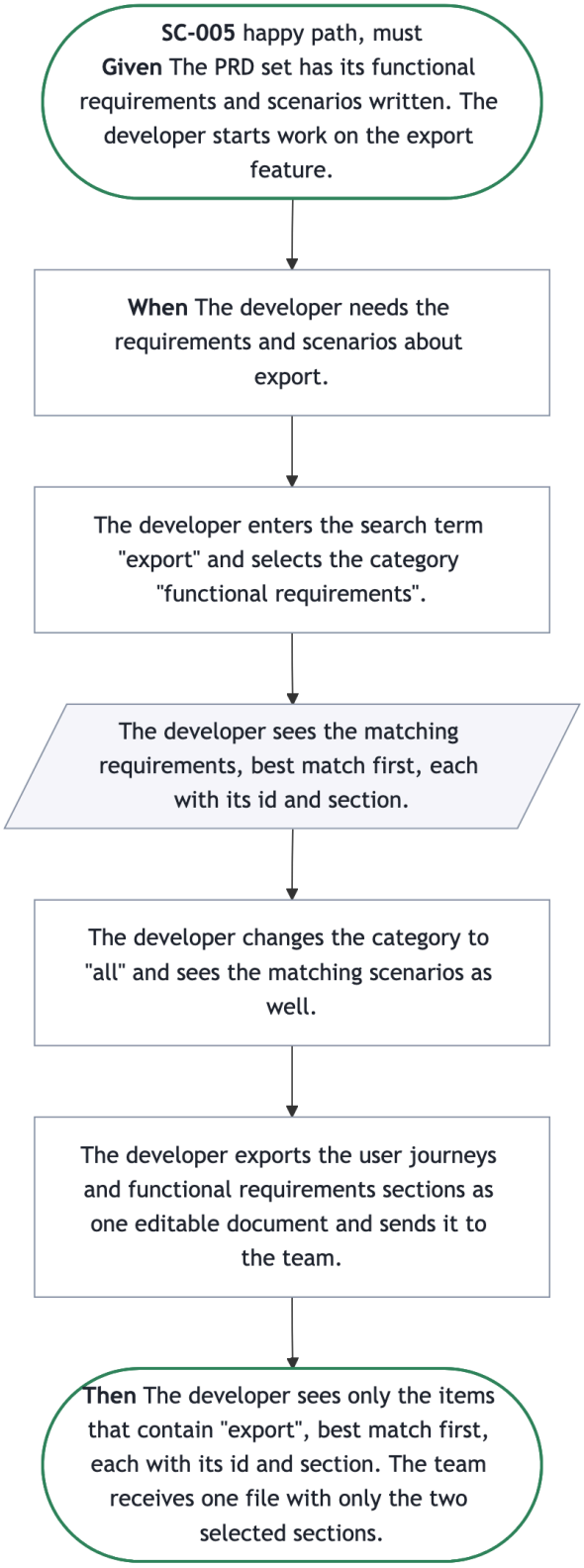
SC-002 scenario



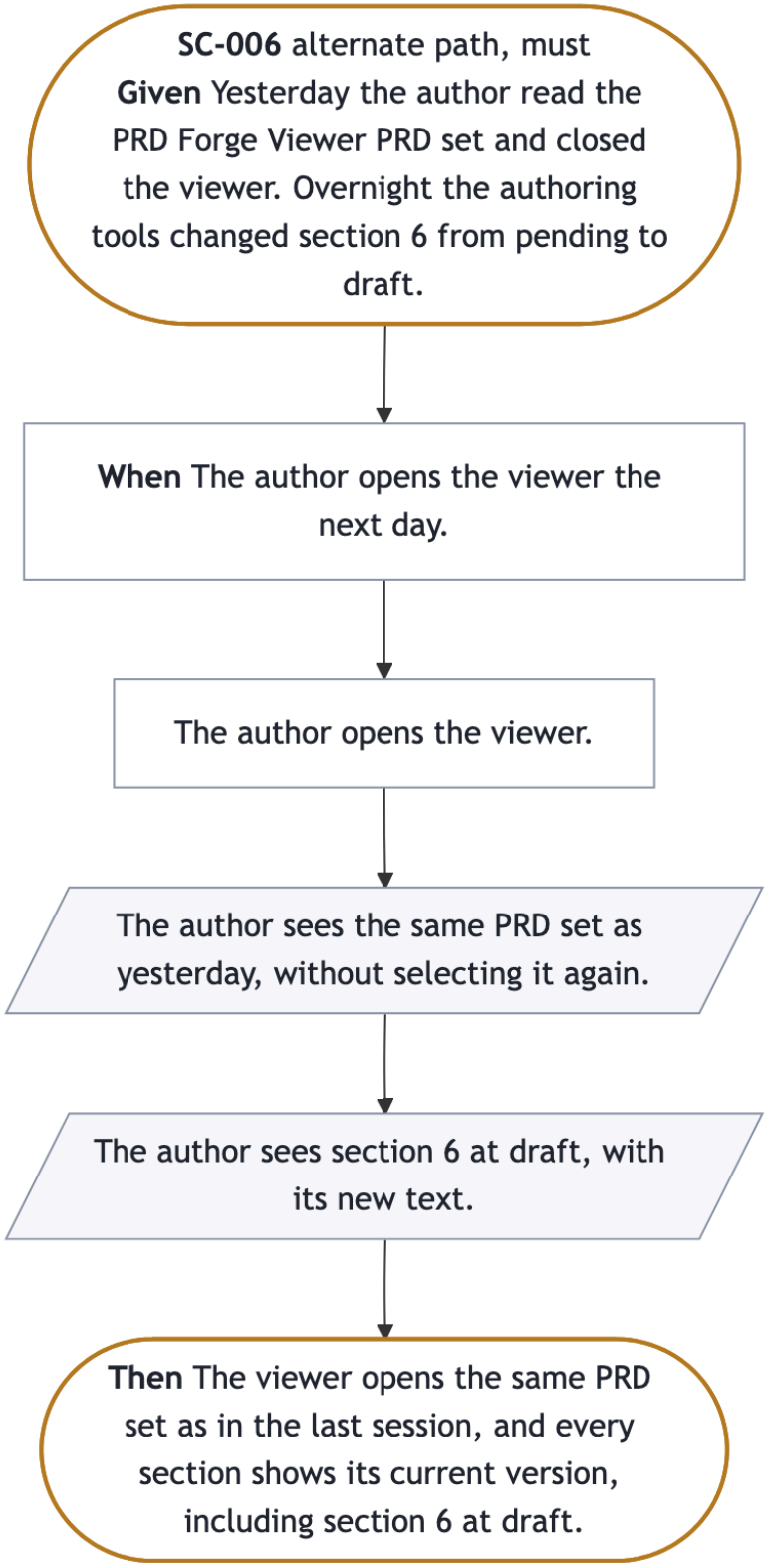
SC-003 scenario



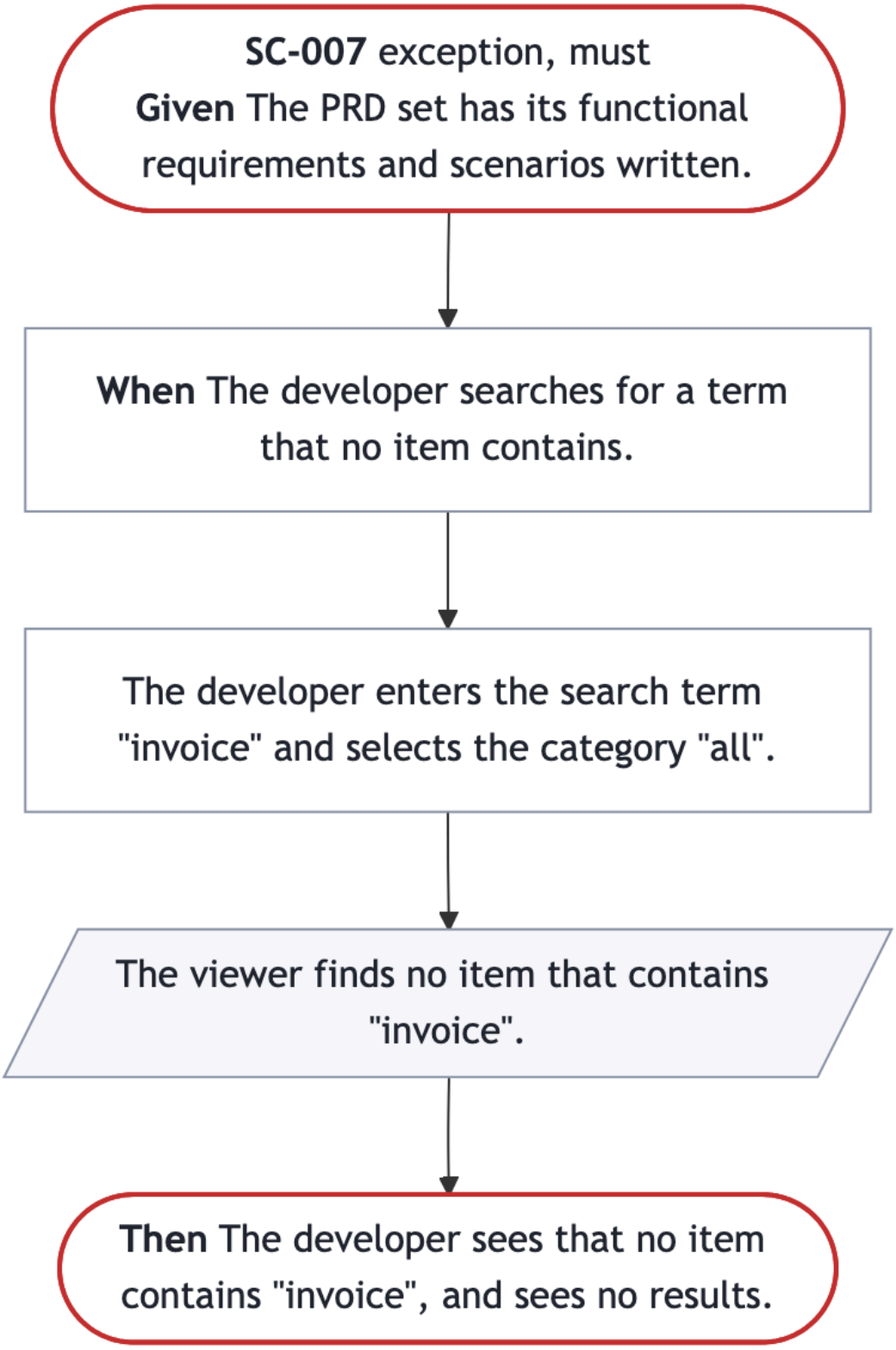
SC-004 scenario



SC-005 scenario



SC-006 scenario



SC-007 scenario

SC-001 is the happy path of the golden thread. It is the end-to-end acceptance test for release 1.

ID	JOURNEY	STAGE	VARIANT	SUMMARY
SC-001	J-001	ST-001	happy	The author fixes a weak section and sends a draft fixed-layout document to the sponsor
SC-002	J-001	ST-001	exception	The PRD set has pending sections and one unreadable section

ID	JOURNEY	STAGE	VARIANT	SUMMARY
SC-003	J-001	ST-004	exception	The authoring tools change a section while the author reads it
SC-004	J-001	ST-005	alternate	The author exports a set that is not complete
SC-005	J-002	ST-009	happy	A developer searches by category and exports two sections
SC-006	J-001	ST-001	alternate	The author reopens the viewer the next day
SC-007	J-002	ST-009	exception	A search finds no match

SC-001. The author sends a draft fixed-layout document to the sponsor

The author opens the set, sees that section 4 has the lowest score (61), fixes it in the authoring tools, and sees the new score in the viewer. The author exports the whole set as a fixed-layout document with the Clay theme. Expected outcome: the sponsor's file shows version 0.1.0, the word "Draft", every section in order, and the status and score of each section.

SC-002. The set has pending sections and one unreadable section

Expected outcome: the set opens, all 18 documents are listed, the unreadable section is marked with its file name, and the other 17 can be read.

SC-003. A section changes while the author reads it

Expected outcome: the viewer shows score 75 and the new text without any action from the author. Section 8 sets the time limit.

SC-004. The author exports a set that is not complete

Expected outcome: the editable document shows "Draft" and the version on the first page, the status and score of every section in the contents list, and "not written yet" for each pending section.

SC-005. A developer searches by category and exports two sections

Expected outcome: the developer sees only the items that contain "export", best match first, and the team receives one file with only the two selected sections.

SC-006. The author reopens the viewer the next day

Expected outcome: the viewer opens the same PRD set as in the last session, and every section shows its current version, including changes made while the viewer was closed.

SC-007. A search finds no match

Expected outcome: the developer sees that no item contains "invoice", and sees no results (FR-008).

Scenarios

SC-001

CONTEXT — The PRD Forge Viewer PRD set has 18 documents. The root document and 4 sections are at draft, and 13 sections are at pending. Section 4 has a score of 61 and 0 blocking defects.

JOURNEY — J-001

STAGE: ST-001

PERSONA: PER-001

VARIANT: happy

PRIORITY: must

TRIGGER: The author wants to send version 0.1.0 to the sponsor for early comments.

COURSE:

- The author opens the PRD set and sees the product name, version 0.1.0, and the status of all 18 documents.
- The author sees that section 4 has a score of 61, the lowest of the graded sections.
- The author goes directly to section 4 and reads it.
- The author fixes section 4 in the authoring tools. The viewer shows the new text and the new score without any action from the author.
- The author exports the whole PRD set as one fixed-layout document with the Clay theme.
- The author sends the file to the product sponsor.
- The sponsor opens the file without the authoring tools and sees on the first page that version 0.1.0 is a draft.

EXPECTED OUTCOME: The sponsor has one fixed-layout document that shows version 0.1.0, the word "Draft", every section in order, and the status and score of each section.

SC-002

CONTEXT: The PRD set has 18 files. Thirteen sections are at pending and fail the authoring tools' check because they have no content yet. One section has a header that cannot be read.

JOURNEY: J-001

STAGE: ST-001

PERSONA: PER-001

VARIANT: exception

PRIORITY: must

TRIGGER: The author opens the PRD set.

COURSE:

- The author opens the PRD set.
- The author sees all 18 documents in order, with the status of each.
- The author sees which section has a header that cannot be read, and the name of its file.
- The author reads the other 17 documents as usual.

EXPECTED OUTCOME: The PRD set opens. All 18 documents are listed. The one unreadable section is marked as unreadable with its file name, and the 17 other documents can be read.

SC-003

CONTEXT	The author reads section 4 in the viewer. Section 4 shows a score of 61. At the same time, the authoring tools rewrite section 4 and grade it at 75.
JOURNEY	J-001
STAGE	ST-004
PERSONA	PER-001
VARIANT	exception
PRIORITY	must
TRIGGER	The authoring tools save the new version of section 4.
COURSE	• The author reads section 4 in the viewer. • The authoring tools save a new version of section 4. • The author sees the new text and the score 75, without any action in the viewer. • The author sees that section 4 changed.
EXPECTED OUTCOME	The viewer shows score 75 and the new text of section 4, and the author did nothing to get it. Section 8 sets the time limit.

SC-004

CONTEXT	The PRD set has the root document and 4 sections at draft, and 13 sections at pending. The engineering lead wants an early copy.
JOURNEY	J-001
STAGE	ST-005
PERSONA	PER-001
VARIANT	alternate
PRIORITY	must
TRIGGER	The author exports the PRD set before the interview covers all sections.
COURSE	• The author selects the whole PRD set, the editable document format, and the Ice Snowstorm theme. • The author saves the file and sends it to the engineering lead. • The engineering lead opens the file without the authoring tools.
EXPECTED OUTCOME	The file shows the word "Draft" and version 0.1.0 on the first page. The contents list shows the status and score of every section. Each pending section says that it is not written yet.

SC-005

CONTEXT	The PRD set has its functional requirements and scenarios written. The developer starts work on the export feature.
JOURNEY	J-002
STAGE	ST-009
PERSONA	PER-002
VARIANT	happy
PRIORITY	must
TRIGGER	The developer needs the requirements and scenarios about export.

COURSE

- The developer enters the search term "export" and selects the category "functional requirements".
- The developer sees the matching requirements, best match first, each with its id and section.
- The developer changes the category to "all" and sees the matching scenarios as well.
- The developer exports the user journeys and functional requirements sections as one editable document and sends it to the team.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

The developer sees only the items that contain "export", best match first, each with its id and section. The team receives one file with only the two selected sections.

SC-006

CONTEXT

Yesterday the author read the PRD Forge Viewer PRD set and closed the viewer. Overnight the authoring tools changed section 6 from pending to draft.

JOURNEY

J-001

STAGE

ST-001

PERSONA

PER-001

VARIANT

alternate

PRIORITY

must

TRIGGER

The author opens the viewer the next day.

COURSE

- The author opens the viewer.
- The author sees the same PRD set as yesterday, without selecting it again.
- The author sees section 6 at draft, with its new text.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

The viewer opens the same PRD set as in the last session, and every section shows its current version, including section 6 at draft.

SC-007 · The PRD set has its functional requirements and scenarios written.

JOURNEY

J-002

STAGE

ST-009

PERSONA

PER-002

VARIANT

exception

PRIORITY

must

TRIGGER

The developer searches for a term that no item contains.

COURSE

- The developer enters the search term "invoice" and selects the category "all".
- The viewer finds no item that contains "invoice".

EXPECTED OUTCOME

The developer sees that no item contains "invoice", and sees no results.

SECTION 6

Scope

FINAL 92/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

Release 1 delivers J-001, the golden thread, from ST-001 to ST-005 in the viewer. ST-006 and ST-007 happen outside the viewer. Release 1 also delivers J-002, from ST-008 to ST-010.

ID	IN SCOPE FOR RELEASE 1	STAGE
IN-001	Open a PRD set and see every document's status; reopen the same set next time	ST-001
IN-002	See status, score, blocking count, and grade date of every section	ST-002
IN-003	Go directly to any section or item in the tree	ST-003
IN-004	Search by term and category, best matches first	ST-009
IN-005	See changes from the authoring tools without any action	ST-004
IN-006	Export the whole set or selected sections as a fixed-layout or editable document (C-001), or print, with version and status	ST-005
IN-007	Select a built-in theme, or make, change, and delete custom themes	ST-005
IN-008	Export only the sections that a developer selects	ST-010

Out of scope for release 1

ID	ITEM	REVISIT WHEN
OUT-001	Editing section text in the viewer	Authors ask to edit without the authoring tools
OUT-002	The findings behind each grade	Release 2, on 2026-11-06 (D-002 delivered).

Non-goals

- We are not building a tool that writes or grades a PRD. The authoring tools do that.
- We are not building a way to send files to stakeholders. The author sends the export with the tools the author already uses.
- We are not building comments inside the viewer.
- We are not building a view of several PRD sets at once.
- We are not building accounts, cloud copies, or shared links.
- We are not building a viewer for PRDs in other formats (C-003).

In scope

IN-001

SUMMARY Open a PRD set and see the product name, the version, the executive summary, and the status of every document. The next session opens the same PRD set.

JOURNEY STAGE ST-001

REQUIREMENTS

- FR-001
- FR-002
- FR-003
- FR-021
- FR-022
- FR-024

IN-002

SUMMARY See the status, score, count of blocking defects, and grade date of every section in one view.

JOURNEY STAGE ST-002

REQUIREMENTS

- FR-004

IN-003 · Go directly to any section and read it.

JOURNEY STAGE ST-003

REQUIREMENTS

- FR-005
- FR-023

IN-004 · Search the PRD set by term, in one category or in all, and see the best matches first.

JOURNEY STAGE ST-009

REQUIREMENTS

- FR-008
- FR-007

IN-005

SUMMARY See each change that the authoring tools make to a section, without any action from the author.

JOURNEY STAGE ST-004

REQUIREMENTS

- FR-009

IN-006

SUMMARY Export the whole PRD set or selected sections as a fixed-layout or an editable document (C-001), or print it. The export shows the version and the status of the PRD and of each section.

JOURNEY STAGE ST-005

REQUIREMENTS

- FR-010
- FR-011
- FR-013
- FR-014
- FR-019

IN-007

SUMMARY: Select an export theme. The viewer includes the built-in themes, and the author can make, change, and delete custom themes.

JOURNEY STAGE: ST-005

REQUIREMENTS:
- FR-015
- FR-016
- FR-017
- FR-018
- FR-020

IN-008 · Export only the sections that a developer selects.

JOURNEY STAGE: ST-010

REQUIREMENTS:
- FR-012

Out of scope

OUT-001 · Editing the text of a section in the viewer (Q-005).

REVISIT: After release 1 ships, when authors ask to edit without the authoring tools.

OUT-002

SUMMARY: Showing the findings behind each grade, such as what is missing and what to improve (Q-004).

REVISIT: The authoring tools record the findings from PRD Forge 0.2.0 (D-002 delivered). Release 2 shows them, on 2026-11-06.

SECTION 7

Functional requirements

DRAFT 91/100 1 BLOCKING

Each requirement uses MoSCoW priority: must, should, could, or won't.

ID	USER	CAPABILITY	PRIORITY	STAGE
FR-001	PER-001	Open a PRD set and see its contents	must	ST-001
FR-002	PER-001	Return to the same PRD set in the next session	must	ST-001
FR-003	PER-001	Open a set with incomplete or unreadable documents	must	ST-001
FR-004	PER-001	See the grades of all sections together	must	ST-002
FR-005	PER-001	Go directly to any section	must	ST-003
FR-006	PER-001	Move to the previous or next section. Dropped: the tree covers it	wont	ST-003
FR-007	PER-002	Follow a reference to the item it names	should	ST-009
FR-008	PER-002	Search by term and category	must	ST-009
FR-009	PER-001	See changes from the authoring tools without any action	must	ST-004
FR-010	PER-001	Export as a fixed-layout document	must	ST-005
FR-011	PER-001	Export as an editable document	must	ST-005
FR-012	PER-002	Export only selected sections	must	ST-010
FR-013	PER-001	Print the set or selected sections	should	ST-005
FR-014	PER-004	See the version, and if it is a draft, in an export	must	ST-005
FR-015	PER-001	Select a built-in export theme	must	ST-005
FR-016	PER-001	Make a custom export theme	must	ST-005
FR-017	PER-001	Change a custom export theme	must	ST-005
FR-018	PER-001	Delete a custom export theme	must	ST-005
FR-019	PER-003	See the status and score of every section in an export	must	ST-005
FR-020	PER-001	Keep custom themes from one session to the next	must	ST-005
FR-021	PER-001	Start the viewer from a terminal with prdf	must	ST-001
FR-022	PER-001	Choose a PRD set from remembered locations	must	ST-001
FR-023	PER-001	Expand a section in the tree and select an item	must	ST-003
FR-024	PER-001	Choose one PRD set when docs/prd holds more than one	must	ST-001

FR-001. Open a PRD set and see its contents

Given a PRD set with 18 documents, when the author opens it, then the author sees the product name, the version, the executive summary, and all 18 documents in order, each with its status.

FR-002. Return to the same PRD set in the next session

The same PRD set opens without any selection, and each section shows its current version.

FR-003. Open a set with incomplete or unreadable documents

All documents are listed. Pending sections show pending. An unreadable section is marked with its file name, and the other documents can be read.

FR-004. See the grades of all sections together

The author sees status, score, blocking count, and grade date for every section. A section with no grade shows that it is not graded.

FR-005. Go directly to any section

From any section, the author reaches any other section in one action.

FR-006. Move to the previous or next section

Dropped on 2026-10-26. The tree (FR-005 and FR-023) moves the author to any section, so the viewer has no previous and next links. The ID stays, and nobody reuses it.

FR-007. Follow a reference to the item it names

From FR-004, the developer follows the reference to ST-002 in J-001.

FR-008. Search by term and category

Each result shows its id, title, section, and a relevance score from 0 to 100, highest first. Selecting a result opens the item. A search with no match says so.

FR-009. See changes from the authoring tools without any action

The author sees a new score and new text without any action, within the time limit in section 8.

FR-010. Export as a fixed-layout document

One fixed-layout document (C-001) holds every document in order. A reader opens it without the authoring tools.

FR-011. Export as an editable document

One editable document (C-001) holds every document in order. A reader opens it without the authoring tools.

FR-012. Export only selected sections

The file contains only the selected sections, in reading order.

FR-013. Print the set or selected sections

The printed copy matches the fixed-layout export in documents, order, and draft mark.

FR-014. See the version, and if it is a draft, in an export

The first page shows the version and "Draft".

FR-015. Select a built-in export theme

The built-in themes are Ice Snowstorm and Clay. The acceptance criteria give the colors and fonts of each.

FR-016. Make a custom export theme

The author selects a page color, a text color, a heading color, an accent color, and a text font and a heading font from serif, sans-serif, and monospace. Exports carry their fonts, so every reader sees the same fonts.

FR-017. Change a custom export theme

Later exports use the changed values. Built-in themes cannot change.

FR-018. Delete a custom export theme

The deleted theme is no longer available. Built-in themes cannot be deleted.

FR-019. See the status and score of every section in an export

The contents list shows the status and score of every section. Each pending section says that it is not written yet.

FR-020. Keep custom themes from one session to the next

A custom theme is still available, with the same values, after the viewer restarts.

FR-021. Start the viewer from a terminal with prdf

The command `prdf` opens the viewer on the PRD set in the current directory, or on the path that the author gives.

FR-022. Choose a PRD set from remembered locations

The viewer remembers every PRD set location that it opened. In a folder with no PRD set, the author picks one from that list.

FR-023. Expand a section in the tree and select an item

The author expands a section in the tree, sees its items by id, and selects one item to read it with the status and grade of its section.

FR-024. Choose one of several PRD sets

When docs/prd holds more than one PRD set, prdf reopens the set that was open in the last session. If none of them was open before, the viewer shows a list of the sets it found, and the author selects one. The PRD owner decided this on 2026-10-26.

FR-001 · Open a PRD set and see its contents

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author sees the product name, the version, the executive summary, and every document of the set in order, each with its status.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a PRD set with 18 documents, when the author opens it, then the author sees the product name, the version, the executive summary, and all 18 documents in order, each with its status.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-001
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; SC-001

FR-002 · Return to the same PRD set in the next session

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author continues with the same PRD set without selecting it again.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author closed the viewer while a PRD set was open, when the author opens the viewer again, then the same PRD set is open without any selection. • Given a section changed while the viewer was closed, when the author opens the viewer again, then the author sees the current version of that section.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-001
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; SC-006

FR-003 · Open a PRD set that has incomplete or unreadable documents

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author reads every readable document and sees which documents cannot be read.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a PRD set with 13 pending sections that have no content, when the author opens it, then all 18 documents are listed and each pending section shows its status as pending. • Given one section that cannot be read, when the author opens the set, then the author sees that section marked as unreadable with its file name, and can read the other 17 documents.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-001
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	SC-002

FR-004 · See the grades of all sections together

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author sees the status, score, count of blocking defects, and grade date of every section at the same time.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given section 4 has score 61 and 0 blocking defects and section 3 has score 75 and 1 blocking defect, when the author views the grades, then the author sees both sections with those values and their grade dates. • Given a section that has no grade, when the author views the grades, then that section shows that it is not graded.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-002
OBJECTIVE	O-002
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; P-003

FR-005 · Go directly to any section

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author reads the selected section without opening other documents first.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author is reading the problem and opportunity section, when the author selects the functional requirements section, then the author sees it in one action.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-003
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; P-001

FR-006 · Move to the previous or the next section in reading order

USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author reads the PRD set from start to end, one section after the other.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author is reading section 4, when the author moves to the next section, then the author sees section 5, user journeys. • Given the author is reading section 4, when the author moves to the previous section, then the author sees section 3, objectives and success metrics. • Given the author is reading the last section, when the author tries to move to the next section, then the author stays on the last section and sees that it is the last one. • Given the author is reading the root document, when the author tries to move to the previous section, then the author stays on the root document and sees that it is the first one.
PRIORITY	wont
SHOWN IN	none
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-003
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26. Dropped on 2026-10-26 by the PRD owner: the tree (FR-005, FR-023) moves the author to any section.

FR-007 · Follow a reference from one item to the item it names

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-002
OUTCOME	The developer reads the related item, such as the journey stage that a requirement serves.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given requirement FR-004 names stage ST-002, when the developer follows that reference, then the developer sees stage ST-002 in J-001.
PRIORITY	should
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-009
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	J-002

FR-008 · Search the PRD set by term, in one category or in all categories

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-002
OUTCOME	The developer sees the matching items, most relevant first, each with its id and section.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the term "export" and the category functional requirements, when the developer searches, then the developer sees only the functional requirements that contain "export", each with its id and section. • Given the same term and the category "all", when the developer searches, then the developer sees matching items from every section, including scenarios. • Given item A has "export" in its title and item B has "export" only once in its text, when the developer searches for "export", then item A is above item B. • Given a search with matches, when the developer views the results, then each result shows its id, its title, its section, and a relevance score from 0 to 100, highest first. • Given a list of results, when the developer selects one result, then the developer sees that item in its section. • Given a term that no item contains, when the developer searches, then the developer sees that there are no matches.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-009
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; SC-005

FR-009 · See changes that the authoring tools make, without any action

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author sees the current version of each section without any action.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author reads section 4 with score 61, when the authoring tools save section 4 with score 75, then the author sees score 75 and the new text without any action, within the time limit in NFR-002. • Given the author reads section 4 when the authoring tools save it, when the new version shows, then the author sees that section 4 changed. • Given the authoring tools change a section the author is not reading, when the author views the grades, then that section shows its new status and score.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-004
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; SC-003

FR-010 · Export the PRD set as a fixed-layout document (C-001)

SHOWN IN	report
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author has one fixed-layout document that a reader opens with software already on the computer, without the authoring tools.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a PRD set with 18 documents, when the author exports the whole set as a fixed-layout document, then one file in the format that C-001 names contains every document in order, and the sponsor opens it without the authoring tools.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; SC-001

FR-011 · Export the PRD set as an editable document (C-001)

SHOWN IN	report
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author has one editable document that a reader opens with software already on the computer, without the authoring tools.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a PRD set with 18 documents, when the author exports the whole set as an editable document, then one file in the format that C-001 names contains every document in order, and the engineering lead opens it in a word processor without the authoring tools.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; SC-004

FR-012 · Export only selected sections

SHOWN IN	report
USER	PER-002
OUTCOME	The developer has one file with only the selected sections.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the developer selects the user journeys section and the functional requirements section, when the developer exports them, then the file contains only those two sections, in reading order.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-010
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; SC-005

FR-013 · Print the PRD set or selected sections

SHOWN IN	report
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author has a printed copy with the same content as the export.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author selects the whole PRD set, when the author prints it, then the printed copy has the same documents, order, and draft mark as the fixed-layout export.
PRIORITY	should
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26

FR-014 · See the version of the PRD, and if it is a draft, in an export

SHOWN IN	report
USER	PER-004
OUTCOME	The sponsor knows which version is in the file, and if it is a draft.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given version 0.1.0 with sections at draft, when the sponsor opens the export, then the first page shows version 0.1.0 and the word "Draft".
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; SC-001, SC-004

FR-015 · Select an export theme from the built-in themes

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The export has the colors and fonts of the selected theme.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the built-in theme Clay, when the author exports with Clay, then the file has page color FAF9F5, text color 3D3D3A, heading color 141413, accent color D97757, a serif font for headings, and a sans-serif font for text. • Given the built-in theme Ice Snowstorm, when the author exports with it, then the file has page color F3F6FB, text color 111111, heading color 0B1F4B, accent color 1D4E89, and a sans-serif font for headings and text.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26

FR-016 · Make a custom export theme

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author exports with colors and fonts that the author selected.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author makes a theme named "Acme" with a page color, a text color, a heading color, an accent color, a text font, and a heading font, each font chosen from serif, sans-serif, and monospace, when the author exports with "Acme", then the file uses those colors and fonts. • Given an export with the theme "Acme", when a reader opens it on a computer that does not have those fonts installed, then the reader sees the same fonts as the author.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26

FR-017 · Change a custom export theme

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	Later exports use the changed colors and fonts.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the custom theme "Acme", when the author changes its accent color and exports, then the file uses the new accent color. • Given a built-in theme, when the author tries to change it, then the built-in theme stays as it was.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26

FR-018 · Delete a custom export theme

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The deleted theme is no longer available for export.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the custom theme "Acme", when the author deletes it, then "Acme" is no longer available to select. • Given a built-in theme, when the author tries to delete it, then the built-in theme is still available.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26

FR-019 · See the status and score of every section in an export

SHOWN IN	report
USER	PER-003
OUTCOME	The engineering lead knows which sections are finished before reading them.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given 13 pending sections, when the engineering lead opens the export, then the contents list shows the status and score of every section. • Given a pending section, when the engineering lead reaches it in the export, then the section says that it is not written yet.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	SC-004

FR-020 · Keep custom export themes from one session to the next

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author uses the same custom themes after the viewer restarts.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author made the custom theme "Acme", when the author closes and reopens the viewer, then "Acme" is available to select, with the same colors and fonts.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26

FR-021 · Start the viewer from a terminal with the command prdf

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author sees the PRD set of the current directory in the viewer, with no other step.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the current directory contains docs/prd with one PRD set, when the author runs prdf, then the viewer opens and shows that PRD set. • Given the author runs prdf with the path of a PRD set, when the viewer opens, then it shows that PRD set. • Given the current directory contains no PRD set, when the author runs prdf, then the author sees that no PRD set was found there, and sees the list of known PRD set locations (FR-022).
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-001
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26

FR-022 · Choose a PRD set from the locations the viewer remembers

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author opens any PRD set opened before, without typing or finding its path.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author opened PRD sets in two different folders before, when the author opens a folder with no PRD set, then the author sees both locations, each with its product name. • Given the list of known locations, when the author selects one, then the viewer opens that PRD set. • Given a known location whose PRD set no longer exists, when the author sees the list, then that location is marked as not found.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-001
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26

FR-023 · Expand a section in the tree and select one of its items

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author reads one item, such as a persona or a requirement, without reading the whole section first.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the users and personas section with PER-001 to PER-005, when the author expands that section in the tree, then the author sees the five persona ids below it. • Given the expanded section, when the author selects PER-001, then the author sees PER-001 with the status and grade of its section.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-003
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	Interview, 2026-10-26; wireframe WF-002

FR-024 · Choose one PRD set when the docs/prd folder holds more than one

SHOWN IN	screen
USER	PER-001
OUTCOME	The author opens the intended PRD set without typing its path.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the current directory contains docs/prd with two PRD sets, and neither set was open in the last session, when the author runs prdf, then the author sees both sets, each with its product name and folder, and the viewer opens neither set. • Given the current directory contains docs/prd with two PRD sets, and one of them was open in the last session, when the author runs prdf, then the viewer opens that set. • Given that list, when the author selects one set, then the viewer opens that PRD set.
PRIORITY	must
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-001
OBJECTIVE	O-001
SOURCE	PRD owner decision, 2026-10-26 (HLD review ADV-02)

SECTION 7

Wireframes

REVIEW 94/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

Each sketch shows what a person sees and what they can do there, with the set's own content. None of them decides how anything looks or how it is built. Every screen has a tree of the PRD set on the left. The person expands the PRD, then a section, then an item.

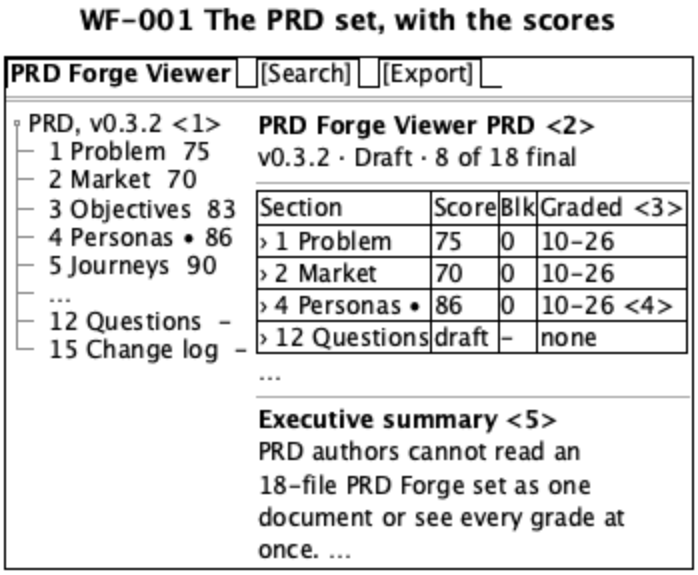
The PRD owner approved WF-001 to WF-009 on 2026-10-26. The sponsor approved the WF-006 change for FR-024 in version 0.3.2. Version 0.3.4 changes the example folder names in WF-006 and waits for approval.

The numbered marks in each sketch are explained, in order, by its `shows` list. Each sketch is also drawn in PlantUML Salt for the printed PRD.

WF-001 The PRD set, with the scores

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-001, FR-002, FR-003, FR-004, FR-005, and FR-009. PER-001 sees it at ST-001.

The author opens the set and sees every section and its grade in one place. Each section in the root page is a link.

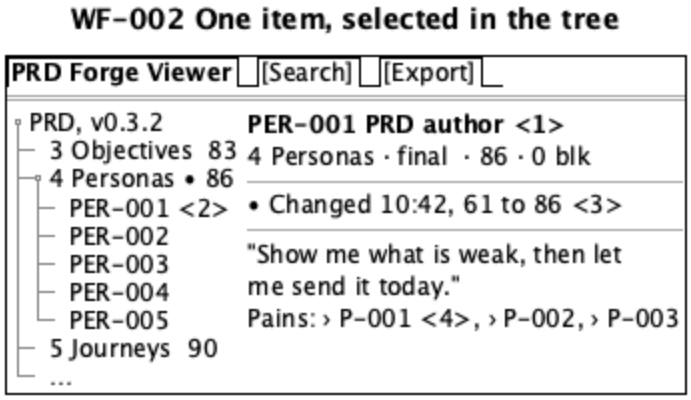


WF-001 drawing

WF-002 One item, selected in the tree

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-005, FR-007, FR-009, and FR-023. PER-001 sees it at ST-003.

The author expands a section and reads one item. The authoring tools changed the section a moment ago.



WF-002 drawing

WF-003 Search results

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-008 and FR-023. PER-002 sees it at ST-009.

The developer searches the requirements for "export". The search computes the relevance scores, so the numbers here only show the order: highest first.

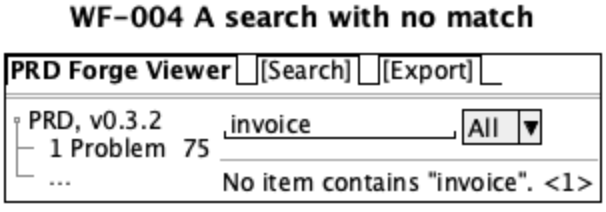


WF-003 drawing

WF-004 A search with no match

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-008. PER-002 sees it at ST-009.

SC-007 names this state.

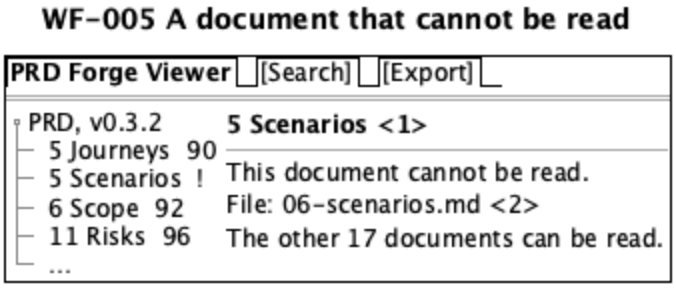


WF-004 drawing

WF-005 A document that cannot be read

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-003. PER-001 sees it at ST-001.

SC-002 names this state.

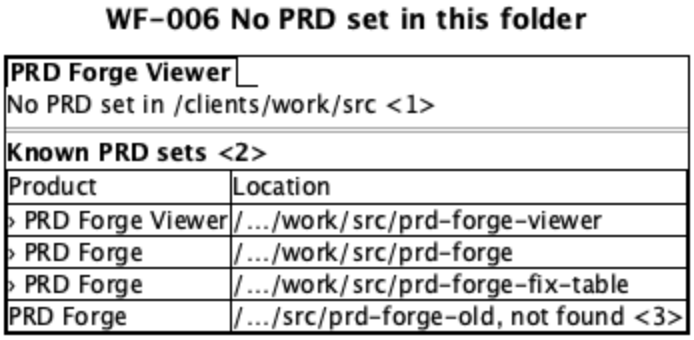


WF-005 drawing

WF-006 No PRD set in this folder

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-021, FR-022, and FR-024. PER-001 sees it at ST-001.

The author runs prdf in a folder with no PRD set. The first three locations are real PRD sets on the owner's computer. The fourth shows a location that no longer exists. When docs/prd holds more than one PRD set, the same screen lists those sets first, and the viewer opens none until the author selects one (FR-024).

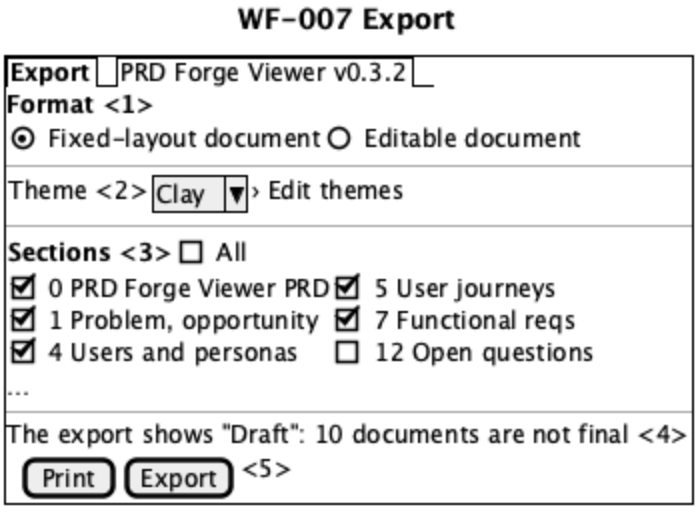


WF-006 drawing

WF-007 Export

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-010, FR-011, FR-012, FR-013, and FR-015. PER-001 sees it at ST-005.

The author exports the whole set, or some sections, in a theme.

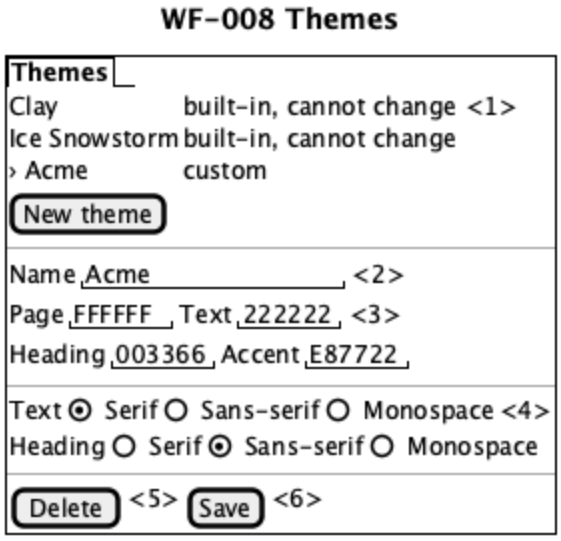


WF-007 drawing

WF-008 Themes

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-015, FR-016, FR-017, FR-018, and FR-020. PER-001 sees it at ST-005.

The author makes and changes the custom theme "Acme", the same theme that the acceptance criteria of FR-016 to FR-018 use. Its colors are the values the author types.

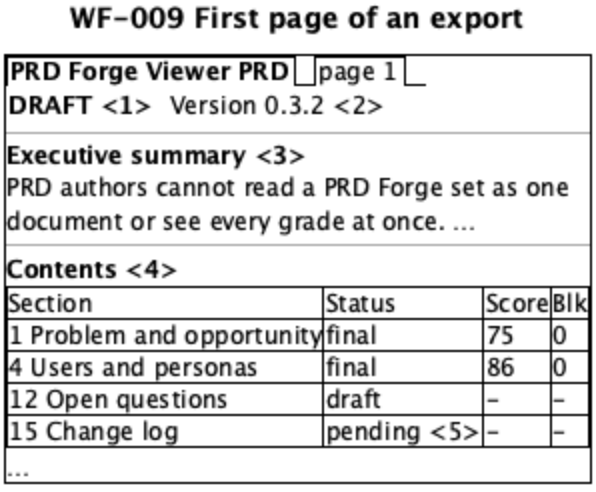


WF-008 drawing

WF-009 First page of an export

Illustration, not a design. Illustrates FR-014, FR-019, and FR-010. PER-004 sees it at ST-011.

The sponsor opens the file without the authoring tools and reads the first page. The contents rows are example values. No section of this set is pending today. The Change log row shows how a pending section looks (SC-004, FR-019).



WF-009 drawing

WF-001 · The PRD set, with the scores

TYPE screen

PERSONA PER-001

JOURNEY STAGE ST-001

ILLUSTRATES

- FR-001
- FR-002
- FR-003
- FR-004
- FR-005
- FR-009

SHOWS

- The tree: the PRD, and below it every section with its score
- The root page: the product name, the version, the draft mark, and the totals
- The grades: each section is a link, with its score and blocking defects
- The change mark on a section that changed
- The executive summary

WF-002 · One item, selected in the tree

TYPE screen

PERSONA PER-001

JOURNEY STAGE ST-003

ILLUSTRATES

- FR-005
- FR-007
- FR-009
- FR-023

SHOWS

- The selected item, with the status and grade of its section
- The selected item in the expanded section
- The change notice
- A reference that opens the item it names

WF-003 · Search results

TYPE screen

PERSONA PER-002

JOURNEY STAGE ST-009

ILLUSTRATES

- FR-008
- FR-023

SHOWS

- The search term and the category
- The number of matches
- The tree opens the section of the selected result
- Each result: relevance score, ID, title, and section

WF-004 · A search with no match

TYPE	screen
PERSONA	PER-002
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-009
ILLUSTRATES	• FR-008
SHOWS	• The no-match message

WF-005 · A document that cannot be read

TYPE	screen
PERSONA	PER-001
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-001
ILLUSTRATES	• FR-003
SHOWS	• The tree and the page both mark the document that cannot be read • The file name of that document

WF-006 · No PRD set in this folder

TYPE	screen
PERSONA	PER-001
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-001
ILLUSTRATES	• FR-021 • FR-022 • FR-024
SHOWS	• The folder where prdf ran • The known locations, each with its product name • A location whose PRD set no longer exists • When docs/prd holds more than one PRD set, the sets found there, above the known locations

WF-007 · Export

TYPE	screen
PERSONA	PER-001
JOURNEY STAGE	ST-005
ILLUSTRATES	• FR-010 • FR-011 • FR-012 • FR-013 • FR-015
SHOWS	• The format, from C-001 • The theme; Edit themes opens WF-008 • The sections to export, in reading order • The reason that the export shows Draft (TR-005) • The print and export buttons

WF-008 · Themes

TYPE screen

PERSONA PER-001

JOURNEY STAGE ST-005

ILLUSTRATES

- FR-015
- FR-016
- FR-017
- FR-018
- FR-020

SHOWS

- The themes; the two built-in themes cannot change
- The name of the custom theme
- The four colors
- The text font and the heading font
- The delete button, for a custom theme only
- The save button; a saved theme is still there after a restart

WF-009 · First page of an export

TYPE report

PERSONA PER-004

JOURNEY STAGE ST-011

ILLUSTRATES

- FR-014
- FR-019
- FR-010

SHOWS

- The draft mark
- The version
- The executive summary
- The contents, with the status, score, and blocking defects of each section
- A section that is not written yet, marked pending

SECTION 8

Non-functional requirements

FINAL 86/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

The PRD owner accepted these targets on 2026-10-26. The test computer is the one in C-004. The author opens the viewer several times a day while writing a PRD (Q-003), so the open and update targets are 2 seconds.

ID	CATEGORY	REQUIREMENT	TARGET
NFR-001	performance	Open a PRD set	p95 at most 2 s
NFR-002	performance	Show a change from the authoring tools	p95 at most 2 s
NFR-003	performance	Show search results	p95 at most 0.5 s
NFR-004	performance	Make an export of the whole set	p95 at most 10 s
NFR-005	privacy	No PRD content leaves the computer	zero transfers
NFR-006	availability	Every feature works offline	100% of FR-001 to FR-024, except FR-006
NFR-007	accessibility	Keyboard-only use, WCAG 2.2 AA	100%, zero failures
NFR-008	durability	Custom themes survive a restart	zero lost
NFR-009	accessibility	Exports work with a screen reader	zero checker errors
NFR-010	security	Only local content shows. No script runs, nothing remote loads	zero scripts, zero requests

Categories that do not apply

- **Retention.** The viewer stores no PRD content. The PRD set stays where the authoring tools keep it (C-002).
- **Scale.** One person uses the viewer on one computer with one PRD set of 18 documents at a time.
- **Observability.** The viewer runs on one person's computer. Failures show to that person, as in FR-003.

NFR-002. Show a change from the authoring tools

This sets the time limit that FR-009 and SC-003 refer to.

NFR-005. No PRD content leaves the computer

The viewer never sends PRD content over a network. The PRD owner accepted this target on 2026-10-26.

NFR-010. Only local content shows

A PRD set can hold a script or a link to a remote image. The viewer shows the text and the local files only. The viewer has no accounts and no shared data. The PRD owner accepted this target on 2026-10-26.

NFR-001 · The author sees a PRD set within 2 seconds of opening it.

CATEGORY	performance
METRIC	Time from the open action to the moment the author sees the product name, the version, and the status of every document.
TARGET	p95 at most 2 seconds, for a PRD set of 18 documents
MEASUREMENT	Open this PRD set 20 times on the test computer (C-004), time each open from a screen recording, and take the 19th fastest time.
PRIORITY	must
APPLIES TO	• FR-001 • FR-002 • FR-003

NFR-002 · The author sees a change from the authoring tools within 2 seconds of the save.

CATEGORY	performance
METRIC	Time from the moment the authoring tools save a section to the moment the author sees the new text and score in the viewer.
TARGET	p95 at most 2 seconds
MEASUREMENT	Change and save one section 20 times while the viewer shows it, on the test computer, time each update from a screen recording, and take the 19th fastest time.
PRIORITY	must
APPLIES TO	• FR-009

NFR-003 · The developer sees search results within 0.5 seconds of searching.

CATEGORY	performance
METRIC	Time from the search action to the moment the developer sees the results.
TARGET	p95 at most 0.5 seconds, for a PRD set of 18 documents
MEASUREMENT	Run 20 searches with different terms and categories on this PRD set, on the test computer, time each from a screen recording, and take the 19th fastest time.
PRIORITY	must
APPLIES TO	• FR-008

NFR-004 · The author has the export file within 10 seconds of starting the export.

CATEGORY	performance
METRIC	Time from the export action to the moment the file is ready to open.
TARGET	p95 at most 10 seconds, for the whole PRD set of 18 documents
MEASUREMENT	Export this PRD set 20 times, 10 times in each format of C-001, on the test computer, time each export, and take the 19th fastest time.
PRIORITY	must
APPLIES TO	• FR-010 • FR-011 • FR-012

NFR-005 · No content of a PRD set leaves the author's computer.

CATEGORY	privacy
METRIC	Number of network transfers that contain any content of a PRD set.
TARGET	Zero
MEASUREMENT	Record all network traffic from the test computer during a session that opens, searches, and exports this PRD set. Search the record for text from the PRD set. The count of matches is zero.
PRIORITY	must

NFR-006 · Every release 1 feature works without a network connection.

CATEGORY	availability
METRIC	Share of the release 1 functional requirements that pass with the network off.
TARGET	100% of the 23 functional requirements
MEASUREMENT	Turn off all network connections on the test computer and run the acceptance criteria of FR-001 to FR-024, except FR-006.
PRIORITY	must

NFR-007 · A person who uses only a keyboard can do every task in the viewer.

CATEGORY	accessibility
METRIC	Share of the release 1 acceptance criteria that a tester completes with a keyboard only, and the count of WCAG 2.2 level AA failures.
TARGET	100% of the acceptance criteria, and zero WCAG 2.2 AA failures
MEASUREMENT	A tester runs the acceptance criteria of FR-001 to FR-024, except FR-006, with a keyboard only, then checks the viewer against the WCAG 2.2 level AA success criteria.
PRIORITY	must

NFR-008 · Custom export themes are not lost when the viewer restarts.

CATEGORY	durability
METRIC	Number of custom themes, or theme values, lost after a restart.
TARGET	Zero
MEASUREMENT	Make 5 custom themes, close the viewer, restart the computer, open the viewer, and compare every value of every theme.
PRIORITY	must
APPLIES TO	• FR-016 • FR-020

NFR-009 · A reader who uses a screen reader can read every export.

CATEGORY	accessibility
METRIC	Number of errors that the built-in accessibility checker of the reader's software reports on an export.
TARGET	Zero errors, for each format in C-001
MEASUREMENT	Export this PRD set in each format of C-001 and run the accessibility checker of a standard PDF reader and of a word processor on each file.
PRIORITY	should
APPLIES TO	• FR-010 • FR-011 • FR-012

NFR-010

STATEMENT	The viewer shows content only from files on the computer. No script in a PRD set runs, and no remote image or link loads.
CATEGORY	security
METRIC	Number of scripts that run, and number of network requests that the viewer makes, while it shows a test PRD set that holds a script in a section, a script in a diagram, a remote image, and a remote link.
TARGET	Zero scripts run and zero network requests
MEASUREMENT	On the test computer, start a network monitor, open the test PRD set, read every section, select the remote link, and count the scripts that run and the network requests.
PRIORITY	must
APPLIES TO	• FR-001 • FR-005 • FR-007 • FR-008 • FR-009 • FR-010 • FR-011 • FR-012 • FR-013 • FR-023

SECTION 9

Constraints

FINAL 75/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

ID	CATEGORY	RULE	AUTHORITY
C-001	policy	Exports are PDF (fixed-layout) and Word .docx (editable)	PRD owner, 2026-10-26
C-002	firm	The viewer never changes a document of a PRD set	PRD owner, 2026-10-26
C-003	standard	The viewer reads the PRD Forge document format, version 1	PRD Forge 0.1.0 schemas
C-004	policy	Release 1 runs on macOS only	PRD owner, 2026-10-26

C-001. Export formats

The stakeholders read PDF and Word files. The requirements say "fixed-layout document" and "editable document"; this constraint names the formats.

C-002. The viewer is read-only

The author changes sections only in the authoring tools, so that every change is graded.

C-003. The PRD Forge document format

The viewer reads PRD sets that follow the PRD Forge version 1 layout and headers.

C-004. Release 1 platform

Release 1 runs on macOS, the operating system of the only test computer. Other operating systems wait for a later release.

C-001

STATEMENT: Exports use the formats that the stakeholders already read. The fixed-layout document is PDF. The editable document is a Microsoft Word document (.docx).

CATEGORY: policy

AUTHORITY: PRD owner decision, Richard Hightower, 2026-10-26. The engineering lead, the sponsor, and the developers without the authoring tools read PDF and Word files.

APPLIES TO:

- FR-010
- FR-011
- FR-012
- FR-013

VERIFICATION: Open each export in a standard PDF reader and in a word processor that reads .docx files, on a computer without the authoring tools.

C-002

STATEMENT

The viewer does not change any document of a PRD set. The author changes documents only in the authoring tools.

CATEGORY

firm

AUTHORITY

PRD owner decision, Richard Hightower, 2026-10-26 (Q-005). Edits go through the authoring tools so that they are graded.

VERIFICATION

Compare every document of a PRD set before and after a session in which the author opens, searches, and exports it. No document has changed.

C-003

STATEMENT

The viewer reads PRD sets in the document layout of the authoring tools, version 1: one root document and 17 section documents with the headers and links that the authoring tools define.

CATEGORY

standard

AUTHORITY

The PRD Forge document format, version 1 (the prd-forge/*@1 schemas), published with PRD Forge 0.1.0.

APPLIES TO

- FR-001
- FR-003
- FR-004

VERIFICATION

Open a PRD set that passes the PRD Forge validator. Every document and every grade shows in the viewer.

C-004

STATEMENT

Release 1 runs on macOS only. Other operating systems come in a later release, after the PRD owner decides.

CATEGORY

policy

AUTHORITY

PRD owner decision, Richard Hightower, 2026-10-26. The only test computer is an Apple silicon Mac with 16 GB of memory.

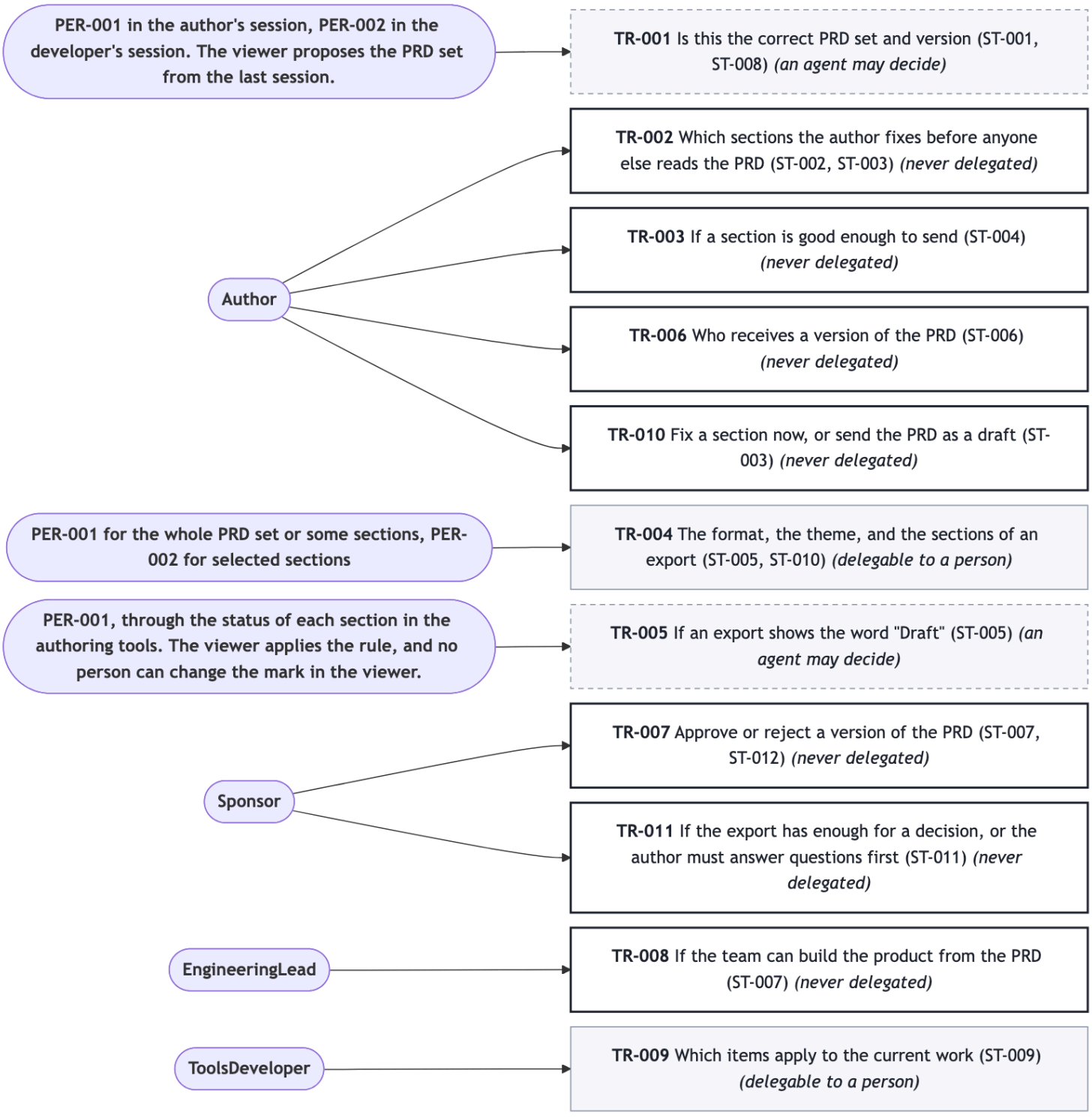
VERIFICATION

Install release 1 on the test computer and run the acceptance criteria of FR-001 to FR-024, except FR-006.

SECTION 10

Decision rights

FINAL 96/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS



Who decides what

A person makes every decision in the journeys, with two exceptions. The viewer proposes the PRD set from the last session (TR-001), and the viewer decides if an export shows "Draft" by a fixed rule (TR-005).

"Software may decide: No" and "Always a person: No" together mean that a person decides, but the viewer can offer a default, such as the last theme used.

- PER-004 approves a version. PER-001, PER-002, PER-003, and PER-005 may not.
- PER-001 decides what goes to whom. The viewer may not send anything.
- No person may remove the "Draft" mark in the viewer.

ID	DECISION	APPROVER	SOFTWARE MAY DECIDE	ALWAYS A PERSON
TR-001	Is this the correct PRD set and version	PER-001, PER-002	Yes, it proposes the last set	No
TR-002	Which sections to fix first	PER-001	No	Yes
TR-003	If a section is good enough to send	PER-001	No	Yes
TR-004	Format, theme, and sections of an export	PER-001, PER-002	No	No
TR-005	If an export shows "Draft"	PER-001, through section status	Yes	No
TR-006	Who receives a version	PER-001	No	Yes
TR-007	Approve or reject a version	PER-004	No	Yes
TR-008	If the team can build from the PRD	PER-003	No	Yes
TR-009	Which items apply to the current work	PER-002	No	No
TR-010	Fix a section now, or send as a draft	PER-001	No	Yes
TR-011	Enough to decide, or ask the author first	PER-004	No	Yes

TR-005. The "Draft" rule

An export shows "Draft" when any document in the PRD set is not at final. The author cannot remove the mark in the viewer. To remove it, the author takes every section to final in the authoring tools. The PRD owner decided this rule on 2026-10-26.

TR-007. approval

Only the sponsor approves a version. The export never says that a PRD is approved. The author records the approval in section 15. The escalation when the sponsor is not available: the approval waits, and nobody else approves (Q-006). When the sponsor rejects a version, the author records the rejection and its reason in section 15, fixes the PRD, and sends a new version.

TR-001 · Is this the correct PRD set and version (ST-001, ST-008)

APPROVER	PER-001 in the author's session, PER-002 in the developer's session. The viewer proposes the PRD set from the last session.
AN AGENT MAY DECIDE	yes
NEVER DELEGATED	no
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The product name and version of the PRD set that is open.
ESCALATION	Nobody else decides. The person who uses the viewer opens a different PRD set at any time.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author closed the viewer with a PRD set open, when the author opens the viewer again, then the same PRD set is open and the author sees its product name and version. • Given the same PRD set reopened, when the author opens a different PRD set, then the different PRD set is open.

TR-002 · Which sections the author fixes before anyone else reads the PRD (ST-002, ST-003)

APPROVER	PER-001
AN AGENT MAY DECIDE	no
NEVER DELEGATED	yes
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The status, score, count of blocking defects, and grade date of every section, in one view.
ESCALATION	The decision waits for the author. Nobody else decides.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given sections with different scores, when the author views the grades, then the viewer shows every section and does not mark any section as "to fix" on its own.

TR-003 · If a section is good enough to send (ST-004)

APPROVER	PER-001
AN AGENT MAY DECIDE	no
NEVER DELEGATED	yes
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The new score, count of blocking defects, and status of the changed section.
ESCALATION	The decision waits for the author. Nobody else decides.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a section that the authoring tools changed, when the author views it, then the author sees its new score, count of blocking defects, and status before choosing to export.

TR-004 · The format, the theme, and the sections of an export (ST-005, ST-010)

APPROVER	PER-001 for the whole PRD set or some sections, PER-002 for selected sections
AN AGENT MAY DECIDE	no
NEVER DELEGATED	no
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The selected format, theme, and sections before the export starts.
ESCALATION	The export waits for the person who makes it. Nobody else decides.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author starts an export, when the author has not selected a format, then the author has no file. • Given the author starts an export, when the author has not selected any section, then the author has no file. • Given the author selects a format, a theme, and sections, when the export finishes, then the author sees the selected format, theme, and sections in the file.

TR-005 · If an export shows the word "Draft" (ST-005)

APPROVER	PER-001, through the status of each section in the authoring tools. The viewer applies the rule, and no person can change the mark in the viewer.
AN AGENT MAY DECIDE	yes
NEVER DELEGATED	no
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The status of every section in the PRD set at the time of export.
ESCALATION	If the author thinks that the mark is wrong, the author changes the status of the sections in the authoring tools and exports again.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the root document and 15 sections at final and 1 section at review, when the author exports, then the first page shows "Draft". • Given all 17 section documents and the root document at final, when the author exports, then the export does not show "Draft". • Given an export that shows "Draft", when the author tries to remove the mark in the viewer, then the mark stays.

TR-006 · Who receives a version of the PRD (ST-006)

APPROVER	PER-001
AN AGENT MAY DECIDE	no
NEVER DELEGATED	yes
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The version and the draft mark of the export.
ESCALATION	The decision waits for the author. Nobody else decides.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given the author makes an export, when the export finishes, then the viewer has sent the file to nobody.

TR-007 · Approve or reject a version of the PRD (ST-007, ST-012)

APPROVER	PER-004
AN AGENT MAY DECIDE	no
NEVER DELEGATED	yes
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The export, with the version, the draft mark, and the status and score of every section.
ESCALATION	When the sponsor is not available, the approval waits. Nobody else approves (Q-006). When the sponsor rejects a version, the author records the rejection and its reason in the change log in section 15, fixes the PRD, and sends a new version.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given any export, when the sponsor opens it, then the export does not say that the PRD is approved. The author records the approval in the change log in section 15.

TR-008 · If the team can build the product from the PRD (ST-007)

APPROVER	PER-003
AN AGENT MAY DECIDE	no
NEVER DELEGATED	yes
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The export, with every section and the status and score of each.
ESCALATION	The engineering lead sends comments to the author, who fixes the PRD in the authoring tools. If the engineering lead is not available, the decision waits.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given an export of the whole PRD set, when the engineering lead opens it, then every section is in the file, with its status and score.

TR-009 · Which items apply to the current work (ST-009)

APPROVER	PER-002
AN AGENT MAY DECIDE	no
NEVER DELEGATED	no
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The matching items, each with its id and section.
ESCALATION	The decision waits for the developer. Nobody else decides.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a search with matches, when the developer views the results, then the viewer selects no item on its own.

TR-010 · Fix a section now, or send the PRD as a draft (ST-003)

APPROVER	PER-001
AN AGENT MAY DECIDE	no
NEVER DELEGATED	yes
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The status, score, and count of blocking defects of the section.
ESCALATION	The decision waits for the author. Nobody else decides.
ACCEPTANCE	• Given a section with 1 blocking defect, when the author exports, then the viewer makes the export and shows "Draft", and does not stop the export.

TR-011

DECISION	If the export has enough for a decision, or the author must answer questions first (ST-011)
APPROVER	PER-004
AN AGENT MAY DECIDE	no
NEVER DELEGATED	yes
EVIDENCE REQUIRED	The version, the draft mark, the executive summary, and the status and score of every section.
ESCALATION	The sponsor asks the author. The approval waits (Q-006).
ACCEPTANCE	• Given an export of the whole PRD set, when the sponsor opens it, then the first two pages show the version, the draft mark, the executive summary, and the contents list with the status and score of every section.

SECTION 11

Assumptions, risks, and dependencies

FINAL 96/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS

Release 1 target date: 2026-10-26. Release 2 target date: 2026-11-06. The PRD owner set both on 2026-10-26.

ID	ASSUMPTION	IF IT IS FALSE
A-001	Stakeholders open PDF and Word without installing anything	C-001, FR-010, and FR-011 change
A-002	The PRD set is on the same computer as the viewer	FR-001, FR-002, NFR-005, and NFR-006 change
A-003	The PRD Forge version 1 format is stable until release 1	C-003, FR-001, FR-003, and FR-004 can fail
A-004	Authors want a viewer, not only the command-line export	O-001 does not move

ID	RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	OWNER
R-001	A PRD Forge format change breaks the viewer	medium	high	Richard Hightower
R-002	Few teams use PRD Forge	medium	medium	Richard Hightower
R-003	Nobody measures the O-001 baseline	medium	medium	Richard Hightower

ID	NEED	FROM	BY	STATUS	BLOCKS
D-001	Stable PRD Forge version 1 format	PRD Forge	2026-10-26	committed	C-003, FR-001, FR-003, FR-004
D-002	PRD Forge records grade findings	PRD Forge	2026-10-26	delivered	OUT-002

D-002 was delivered in PRD Forge 0.2.0, which writes the reasons for each grade beside each section.

Assumptions

> **A-001 · Stakeholders open PDF and Word files without installing anything.**
>
> IF FALSE — C-001 changes, and FR-010 and FR-011 need other formats.
>
> VALIDATED BY — Send the first export of this PRD to PER-003 and PER-004 and ask.
>
> OWNER — Richard Hightower

> **A-002 · The PRD set is on the same computer as the viewer.**
>
> IF FALSE — FR-001 and FR-002 change, and NFR-005 and NFR-006 need new targets.
>
> VALIDATED BY — Ask the first three authors where they keep their PRD sets.
>
> OWNER — Richard Hightower

> **A-003 · The PRD Forge version 1 format stays the same until release 1 ships.**
>
> IF FALSE — C-003 changes, and FR-001, FR-003, and FR-004 can fail on new files (R-001).
>
> VALIDATED BY — D-001.
>
> OWNER — Richard Hightower

A-004 · Authors want a viewer, and the current command-line export is not enough for them.

IF FALSE	O-001 does not move because of the viewer, and P-001 and P-002 need a different answer.
VALIDATED BY	Measure O-001 on this PRD with and without the viewer (Q-001).
OWNER	Richard Hightower

Risks

R-001 · A change to the PRD Forge document format breaks the viewer.

LIKELIHOOD	medium
IMPACT	high
MITIGATION	C-003 fixes the format at version 1. FR-003 shows each unreadable document by name. D-001 keeps the format stable for release 1.
OWNER	Richard Hightower

R-002 · Few teams use PRD Forge, so the viewer has few users.

LIKELIHOOD	medium
IMPACT	medium
MITIGATION	Measure O-001 on this PRD first, and report it by 2027-03-31.
OWNER	Richard Hightower

R-003 · Nobody measures the baseline for O-001, so nobody can show success.

LIKELIHOOD	medium
IMPACT	medium
MITIGATION	Q-001, due 2026-11-30.
OWNER	Richard Hightower

Dependencies

D-001 · PRD Forge keeps the version 1 document format stable until release 1 ships.

FROM	PRD Forge maintainers, owned by Richard Hightower
BY	2026-10-26
STATUS	committed
BLOCKS	• C-003 • FR-001 • FR-003 • FR-004

D-002 · PRD Forge records the findings behind each grade in the PRD set.

FROM	PRD Forge maintainers, owned by Richard Hightower
BY	2026-10-26
STATUS	delivered
BLOCKS	• OUT-002

SECTION 12

Open questions

DRAFT

Questions are collected during the interview and consolidated later.

ID	QUESTION	DECIDER	BY
Q-001	How long from a finished PRD to stakeholder feedback today?	Richard Hightower	2026-11-30
Q-002	How many stakeholders review a PRD, and how many have the tools?	Richard Hightower	2026-11-30
Q-003	How often do PER-001 and PER-002 open a PRD in the viewer? Answered: the author, several times a day.	Richard Hightower	2026-11-30
Q-004	Must release 1 show the findings behind each grade? Answered: no, later, after a change to the authoring tools.	Richard Hightower	2026-11-30
Q-005	Is editing text in the viewer in release 1? Answered: no, it is a later feature.	Richard Hightower	2026-10-26
Q-006	Who approves when the sponsor is not available? Answered: nobody, the approval waits.	Richard Hightower	2026-11-30
Q-007	When must PRD Forge record grade findings? Answered: PRD Forge 0.2.0 does it now.	Richard Hightower	2026-10-26
Q-008	What other unhappy path does J-002 need?	Richard Hightower	2026-11-30

Q-001. Time from a finished PRD to stakeholder feedback

Measure it on this PRD as the baseline. Blocks the cost of inaction for P-001 and P-002.

Q-002. Stakeholders per PRD, and how many have the tools

Blocks the evidence for P-002.

Q-003. How often PER-001 and PER-002 open a PRD in the viewer

Answered on 2026-10-26: the author opens the viewer several times a day.

Q-004. The findings behind each grade

Answered on 2026-10-26: the findings are a later feature. The feature depends on a change to the authoring tools so that they record the findings in the PRD set. Release 1 shows the status, score, blocking count, and grade date.

Q-005. Editing text in the viewer

Answered on 2026-10-26: editing is a later feature, not in release 1. The author changes sections only in the authoring tools. Section 6 records it as a non-goal for release 1.

Q-006. Approval when the sponsor is not available

Answered on 2026-10-26: the approval waits until the sponsor is available.

Q-007. Date for the grade findings

Answered on 2026-10-26: PRD Forge 0.2.0 records the findings now (D-002 delivered).

Q-008. A second unhappy path for J-002

J-002 has one happy scenario (SC-005) and one exception (SC-007), a search with no match. The PRD owner decides by 2026-11-30 if release 1 needs another one.

Q-001

QUESTION	How long does it take today from a finished PRD to stakeholder feedback? The PRD owner estimates about 10 days. Measure it on this PRD to replace the estimate.
DECIDER	Richard Hightower
BY	2026-11-30
BLOCKS	• P-001 • P-002

Q-002

QUESTION	How many stakeholders review a typical PRD, and how many of them have Claude Code and PRD Forge?
DECIDER	Richard Hightower
BY	2026-11-30
BLOCKS	• P-002

Q-003

QUESTION	How often do the PRD author (PER-001) and the developer who uses PRD Forge (PER-002) open a PRD in the viewer?
DECIDER	Richard Hightower
BY	2026-11-30
BLOCKS	• PER-001 • PER-002
ANSWER	Answered on 2026-10-26. The author opens the viewer several times a day while writing a PRD. The frequency for PER-002 is not known.

Q-004

QUESTION
The findings behind each grade (what is missing and what to improve) are not kept in the PRD set today. Must release 1 show them, and if so, who records them so that the author can see them later?

DECIDER
Richard Hightower

BY
2026-11-30

BLOCKS
- ST-002
- ST-003
- P-003

ANSWER
Answered on 2026-10-26. Release 1 does not show the findings behind each grade. That is a later feature, and it depends on a change to the authoring tools so that they record the findings in the PRD set. Release 1 shows the status, score, blocking count, and grade date that the authoring tools already record.

Q-005 · Is editing text in the viewer in release 1?

DECIDER
Richard Hightower

BY
2026-10-26

ANSWER
No. Editing in the viewer is a later feature. In release 1 the author changes sections only in the authoring tools. Section 6 records this as a non-goal for release 1.

Q-006

QUESTION
When the sponsor (PER-004) is not available to approve a version, who approves it, or does the approval wait?

DECIDER
Richard Hightower

BY
2026-11-30

BLOCKS
- TR-007

ANSWER
Answered on 2026-10-26. The approval waits until the sponsor is available. Nobody else approves.

Q-007

QUESTION
By what date must PRD Forge record the findings behind each grade (D-002), and in which release does the viewer show them (OUT-002)?

DECIDER
Richard Hightower

BY
2026-10-26

BLOCKS
- D-002
- OUT-002

ANSWER
Answered on 2026-10-26. PRD Forge 0.2.0 already writes the reasons for each grade to a grades file beside each section, so D-002 is delivered. The PRD owner decides when the viewer shows them.

Q-008

QUESTION
J-002 has one happy scenario (SC-005) and one exception (SC-007). What other way can a developer's search or export of selected sections go wrong, and must release 1 handle it?

DECIDER
Richard Hightower

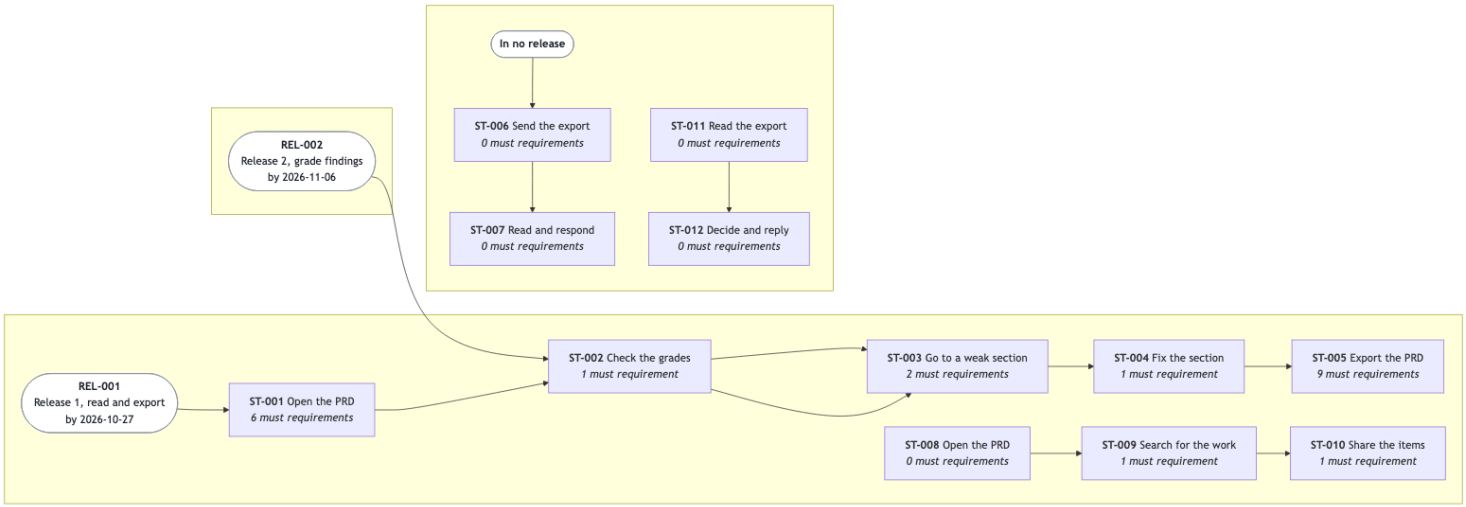
BY
2026-11-30

BLOCKS
- J-002

SECTION 13

Release plan

FINAL 92/100 NO BLOCKING DEFECTS



The release line

ID	RELEASE	TARGET DATE	STAGES	REQUIREMENTS
REL-001	Release 1, read and export	2026-10-27	ST-001 to ST-005, ST-008 to ST-010	FR-001 to FR-024, except FR-006
REL-002	Release 2, grade findings	2026-11-06	ST-002, ST-003	Added after D-002

REL-001. Release 1, read and export

The author reads the whole PRD set, sees the grades, and sends a themed PDF or Word export with a draft mark. A developer searches and exports selected sections. ST-006 and ST-007 happen outside the viewer. The PRD owner moved the target date from 2026-10-26 to 2026-10-27 on 2026-10-26. Release 1 runs on macOS only (C-004).

REL-002. Release 2, grade findings

The author sees the findings behind each grade. D-002 is delivered, so this release can start when the PRD owner decides. Editing in the viewer (OUT-001) has no release yet.

REL-001 · Release 1, read and export

OUTCOMES

- The author opens a PRD set, sees the grade of every section in one view, goes to any section, and sees changes from the authoring tools without any action.
- The author sends stakeholders a PDF or Word export, in a theme the author selects, that shows the version and the draft mark.
- A developer searches the PRD set by term and category and exports selected sections.

JOURNEY STAGES

- ST-001
- ST-002
- ST-003
- ST-004
- ST-005
- ST-008
- ST-009
- ST-010

REQUIREMENTS

- FR-001
- FR-002
- FR-003
- FR-004
- FR-005
- FR-007
- FR-008
- FR-009
- FR-010
- FR-011
- FR-012
- FR-013
- FR-014
- FR-015
- FR-016
- FR-017
- FR-018
- FR-019
- FR-020
- FR-021
- FR-022
- FR-023
- FR-024

OBJECTIVES

- O-001

TARGET DATE

2026-10-27

REL-002 · Release 2, grade findings

OUTCOMES

- The author sees, for each section, the findings behind its grade: what is missing and what to improve.

JOURNEY STAGES

- ST-002
- ST-003

OBJECTIVES

- O-001
- O-002

TARGET DATE

2026-11-06

SECTION 14

Glossary

DRAFT

Each term enters the glossary when it first appears in the interview.

TERM	MEANING
PRD set	One PRD as 18 linked documents. The unit of work.
section	One of the 17 section documents in a PRD set.
authoring tools	The tools that write and grade the PRD set. Today: PRD Forge in Claude Code.
grade	A score from 0 to 100, a blocking-defect count, and a date.
blocking defect	A fault that stops a section from going to review or final.
status	pending, draft, review, or final.
golden thread	The one journey that release 1 must deliver end to end (J-001).
journey	The stages that one persona goes through to reach one goal.
stage	One large step of a journey.
persona	One role that uses the product or approves something about it.
export	A document file or printed copy that a reader opens without the authoring tools.
export theme	A named set of colors and fonts that controls how an export looks.
MoSCoW priority	must, should, could, or won't.
built-in theme	A theme that comes with the viewer: Ice Snowstorm or Clay.
fixed-layout document	An export whose pages look the same everywhere. Format in C-001.
unreadable document	A document whose header the viewer cannot read. Pending is not unreadable.
contents list	The list of every document, in reading order, at the start of an export.
reading order	Root document first, then each section by its order number.
editable document	An export that a reader can change in a word processor. Format in C-001.

PRD set

MEANING

One PRD as 18 linked documents: one root index with the executive summary, and 17 section documents. The unit of work for every persona.

SEE ALSO

- section
- authoring tools

section

MEANING — One of the 17 section documents in a PRD set, such as problem and opportunity, user journeys, or functional requirements.

authoring tools

MEANING — The tools that interview the author, write the PRD set, and grade each section. Today these are PRD Forge, used inside Claude Code. The viewer reads their output and does not replace them.

NOT — The viewer. The viewer reads and exports a PRD set; it does not write or grade it.

grade

MEANING — The result of checking one section against its rubric: a score from 0 to 100, a count of blocking defects, and the date of the check.

SEE ALSO
- blocking defect

blocking defect

MEANING — A fault in a section that stops it from going to review or final, whatever its score.

status

MEANING — The stage of a section or of the PRD set: pending (not interviewed), draft (written), review (with reviewers), or final (approved).

NOT — A review meeting. "Review" is a status.

golden thread

MEANING — The one journey that release 1 must deliver end to end. In this PRD it is J-001.

journey

MEANING — The stages that one persona goes through to reach one goal, from start to end, including steps outside the product.

SEE ALSO
- stage

stage

MEANING — One large step of a journey, with an actor, inputs, outputs, and a decision.

persona

MEANING — One role that uses the product or approves something about it.

export

MEANING — A copy of the whole PRD set or of selected sections, as one document file or as a printed copy, that a reader opens without the authoring tools.

SEE ALSO
- export theme

export theme

MEANING — A named set of colors and fonts that controls how an export looks. Some themes come with the viewer, and the author can make more.

MoSCoW priority

MEANING — The priority of a requirement: must (release 1 needs it), should (important, not essential for release 1), could (if time allows), or won't (not in this release).

built-in theme

MEANING — An export theme that comes with the viewer and that the author cannot change or delete. Release 1 has two: Ice Snowstorm and Clay.

SEE ALSO
- export theme

fixed-layout document

MEANING — An export file whose pages look the same on every computer and that the reader cannot easily change. C-001 names the format.

editable document

MEANING — An export file that the reader can open and change in a word processor. C-001 names the format.

unreadable document

MEANING — A document in a PRD set whose header the viewer cannot read, so its id, kind, title, or status is not known. A pending section with no content is not unreadable.

contents list

MEANING — The list of every document of the PRD set, in reading order, at the start of an export.

reading order

MEANING — The order of the documents in a PRD set: the root document first, then each section by its order number.

prdf

MEANING — The terminal command that starts the viewer, short for PRD Forge.

item

MEANING — Any entry in a PRD set that has an id, such as FR-008, SC-003, PER-002, or Q-004, and any glossary term. One search result is one item.

item title

MEANING — The first named field of an item: its name, capability, statement, question, or term.

category

MEANING — A filter for search: one category for each kind of section, such as functional requirements or scenarios, plus "all".

relevance score

MEANING — A number from 0 to 100 on each search result. Matches in the item title score higher than matches in the text, and more matches score higher.

known location

MEANING — A folder where the viewer opened a PRD set before. The viewer remembers it.

SECTION 15

Change log

DRAFT

VERSION	DATE	AUTHOR	SUMMARY	APPROVALS
0.1.0	2026-10-26	Richard Hightower	First draft of all 15 sections	None yet
0.2.0	2026-10-26	Richard Hightower	prdf, known locations, search scores, fonts; 10 sections to review	None yet
0.3.0	2026-10-26	Richard Hightower	PRD Forge 0.5.1 fields, wireframes WF-001 to WF-009, FR-023 added, FR-006 dropped	Richard Hightower, sponsor, approved 2026-10-26
0.3.1	2026-10-26	Richard Hightower	WF-009 shows a pending section	Richard Hightower, sponsor, approved 2026-10-26
0.3.2	2026-10-26	Richard Hightower	HLD review decisions: date, macOS, FR-024, NFR-010	Richard Hightower, sponsor, approved 2026-10-26
0.3.3	2026-10-26	Richard Hightower	FR-024 reopens the last set	None yet
0.3.4	2026-10-27	Richard Hightower	Neutral folder names in WF-006	None yet

0.1.0. First draft

The interview wrote all 15 sections. The decisions recorded on 2026-10-26:

- Editing in the viewer is not in release 1 (Q-005, OUT-001).
- Grade findings wait for a later release and a PRD Forge change (Q-004, D-002).
- Search and custom export themes are in release 1.
- Every export shows "Draft" until every document is final (TR-005).
- PDF and Word are the export formats (C-001).
- When the sponsor is not available, the approval waits (Q-006).
- The release 1 target date is 2027-01-31.
- The viewer is free and open source for anyone who uses PRD Forge.

Versions 0.1.0 and 0.2.0 have no approval.

0.3.0. Approved by the sponsor

Richard Hightower approved version 0.3.0 as the sponsor (PER-004) on 2026-10-26. The 14 graded sections moved from review to final. The root, open questions, glossary, and change log stay at draft, so every export still shows "Draft" (TR-005).

0.3.1. A pending section in WF-009

WF-009 now shows how a pending section looks in the contents of an export. The wireframes section returned to review. Richard Hightower approved version 0.3.1 as the sponsor (PER-004) on 2026-10-26, and the wireframes moved to final.

0.3.2. Decisions from the HLD review

The PRD owner decided four items from the HLD review on 2026-10-26:

- REL-001 moves from 2026-10-26 to 2026-10-27 (ADV-07).
- Release 1 runs on macOS only. Other operating systems come later (C-004, ADV-03).
- When docs/prd holds more than one PRD set, the author picks one in the viewer (FR-024, ADV-02).
- The viewer shows only local content. No script runs, and nothing remote loads (NFR-010, ADV-01).

Scope, functional requirements, wireframes, non-functional requirements, constraints, and the release plan returned to review. Richard Hightower approved version 0.3.2 as the sponsor (PER-004) on 2026-10-26. Five of them moved to final. Functional requirements stay at draft: the adversarial grade found one blocking defect (ST-008 has no `must` requirement).

0.3.3. FR-024 reopens the last set

When docs/prd holds more than one PRD set, the viewer reopens the set that was open in the last session. The list of sets shows only when none of them was open before. This settles which rule wins between FR-002 and FR-024. Functional requirements stay at draft until ST-008 has a `must` requirement.

0.3.4. Neutral folder names in WF-006

The example folders in WF-006 no longer name a client. The wireframes returned to review until the sponsor approves this version.

> **First draft of all 15 sections from the PRD Forge interview. Decisions on 2026-10-26: edit**
>
> VERSION 0.1.0
>
> DATE 2026-10-26
>
> AUTHOR Richard Hightower
>
> SECTIONS
> - 1
> - 2
> - 3
> - 4
> - 5
> - 6
> - 7
> - 8
> - 9
> - 10
> - 11
> - 12
> - 13
> - 14
> - 15

Engineering review fixes and new decisions. Added FR-021 (the prdf command) and FR-022 (re

VERSION 0.2.0

DATE 2026-10-26

AUTHOR Richard Hightower

SECTIONS
- 2
- 4
- 5
- 6
- 7
- 8
- 9
- 11
- 12
- 13
- 14

Updated to PRD Forge 0.5.1. Added persona short names, stage acceptance, scenario prioriti

VERSION 0.3.0

DATE 2026-10-26

AUTHOR Richard Hightower

SECTIONS
- 4
- 5
- 7
- 12

APPROVALS

Richard Hightower

ROLE Sponsor (PER-004)

DATE 2026-10-26

DECISION approved

WF-009 shows a pending section in the contents, and sections 1 and 4 as final. The wirefra

VERSION 0.3.1

DATE 2026-10-26

AUTHOR Richard Hightower

SECTIONS
- 7

APPROVALS

Richard Hightower

ROLE Sponsor (PER-004)

DATE 2026-10-26

DECISION approved

Decisions from the HLD review. Release 1 moves to 2026-10-27. Release 1 runs on macOS only

VERSION	0.3.2
DATE	2026-10-26
AUTHOR	Richard Hightower
SECTIONS	• 6 • 7 • 8 • 9 • 13

APPROVALS

Richard Hightower

ROLE	Sponsor (PER-004)
DATE	2026-10-26
DECISION	approved

FR-024 reopens the set that was open in the last session. The list of sets shows only when

VERSION	0.3.3
DATE	2026-10-26
AUTHOR	Richard Hightower
SECTIONS	• 7

WF-006 uses neutral example folder names. The wireframes return to review until the sponso

VERSION	0.3.4
DATE	2026-10-27
AUTHOR	Richard Hightower
SECTIONS	• 7